



The Life, Works, and Writings of Jose Rizal

PRELIM PERIOD

CHAPTER 1 #WhyStudyRIZAL?

Chapter Description:

The Filipino nation is a project. Deemed "immortal," yet it has to be nurtured, refined, and strengthened so it may continue to exist. The responsibility lies in its members. Every Filipino must imbibe the complete essence of belonging to one nation. Having a citizenship in title alone is just an entry point. One should imagine his/her role in the society and be an active participant in the collective endeavor of building the nation. Studying the life, works, and writings of Jose Rizal may be employed in this grand scheme.

This chapter will discuss the conceptual framework of the Rizal Course. It is divided into four lessons which are expected to inculcate awareness and understanding into the minds of students about the relevance of studying the life, works, and writings of Jose Rizal

Chapter Outcomes:

At the end of the chapter, the students should be able to:

1. identify the qualities of a hero;
2. discuss the provisions of the Rizal Law and why it was established; and
3. relate the role of symbols and heroism in the process of nation building

LESSON 1

Republic Act 1425 (Rizal Law)

Lesson Outcomes:

At the end of the lesson, the students should be able to:

1. discuss the democratic process that led to the promulgation of the Rizal Law;
2. examine the goals of the Rizal Law; and
3. interpret the role of the youth as implied in the Rizal Law.

Lesson Introduction:

Cemented in history as potent symbol of the nation, Rizal's heroism was sponsored by the nation through Republic Act 1425 (Rizal Law) of June 12, 1956, with the younger generations, the "Millennials," receiving much importance. This lesson analyzes the Rizal Law to stress the significance of Dr. Jose Rizal, a national hero and foremost exemplar of Filipino heroism, in fostering a sense of nationalism, especially to the fair hopes of the nation --the youth.

What is The Rizal Law?

The Rizal Law, also known as **RA 1425**, is an act to **include in the curricula** of all public and private schools, colleges and universities courses on the **life, works and writings of Jose Rizal**, particularly his novels **Noli me Tangere** and **El Filibusterismo**, authorizing the printing and distribution thereof, and for other purposes.



Lesson Discussion:

The Birth of the Rizal Law Amidst the destruction of building infrastructures, roads, and bridges brought by World War II, the people saw the need to rebuild the Filipino identity which was equally affected by the war. Nationalist policy-makers did not waste any time and painstakingly redirected the nation to the essence of History as a foundation

of national hope and pride. Education became the primary weapon of reorientation while prioritizing the youth as the bearers of country's future.

Much attention was apportioned to the ideals of freedom and nationalism of Filipino heroes. Jose Rizal was an obvious platform from a start since his name dominates the pantheon of heroes. On April 3, 1956, Senate Bill No. 438 (AN ACT TO MAKE NOLI ME TANGERE AND EL FILIBUSTERISMO COMPULSORY READING MATTER IN ALL PUBLIC AND PRIVATE COLLEGES AND UNIVERSITIES AND FOR OTHER PURPOSES) was submitted to the Senate Committee on Education Senator Jose P. Laurel, the Chairman of the Committee, sponsored and presented the bill to the members of the Upper House on April 17, 1956. The main purpose of the bill according to Senator Laurel was to disseminate the ideas and ideals of Jose Rizal through the reading of his works, notably his novels *Noli Me Tangere* and *El Filibusterismo*. He stated that:

Noli Me Tangere and *El Filibusterismo* must be read by all Filipinos. They must be taken to heart, for in their pages we see ourselves as in a mirror our defects as well as our strength, our virtues as well as our vices. Only then Would we become conscious as a people, and so learn to prepare ourselves for painful sacrifices that ultimately lead to self-reliance, self-respect and freedom (Laurel, Jr, 131).

Debates for the bill in aid of legislation ensued next, albeit not smooth sailing Opponents, mostly rabid Catholic senators, contended that the proposed bill was too controversial. Their arguments were as follows:

1. The bill was an attempt to discredit the Catholic religion.
2. Inimical to the tenets of the faith to which 170 lines in *Noli Me Tangere* and 50 lines in *El Filibusterismo* were offensive to the Church doctrine,
3. The bill might divide the nation.
4. Compulsion to read something against one's faith impaired freedom of speech and religious freedom.

Heated exchange continued as part of the democratic process. Opposition to the bill Senator Francisco "Soc" Rodrigo stood up and delivered his speech:

Avast majority of our people are at the same time Catholics and Filipino citizens. As such, they have two great loves: their country and their faith. These two loves are no conflicting loved. They are harmonious affections, like the love of a child for his father and for his mother. This is the basis of my stand. Let us not create a conflict between nationalism and religion; the government and the church (Laurel, Jr., 132).

Vehemently refuting the arguments of opposition, Senator Claro M. Recto exclaimed that the novels have no intentions of discrediting the Church. More so, he said that the bill only aims to contextualize Rizal's heroism in the face of Spanish tyranny. He then uttered these words:

Rizal did not pretend to teach religion or theology when he wrote those books. He aimed at inculcating civic consciousness in the Filipinos, national dignity, personal pride, and patriotism...but while he criticized and ridiculed the unworthy behavior of certain ministers of the church, he made exceptions in favor of the worthy ones, like the Dominican friar, Padre Fernandez, and the virtuous native priest, Padre Florentino, and the Jesuits in general (Laurel, Jr., 132-133).

Meanwhile, a similar bill (House Bill No. 5561) was filed by Congressman Jacobo Z. Gonzales in the House of Representatives. As expected, the bill was welcomed by dissenting opinions. Different face but same stance, the bill was attacked based on its constitutionality and religiosity. With this setback both in the Upper House and the Lower House, it seemed hopeless for the bill to pass into law in the latter part of April 1956.

It was in this context that Senator Laurel proposed a substitute bill. The inclusion of all works and writings of Jose Rizal, not just the two novels, was the main feature of this bill. He then stressed the removal of the term "compulsion" to appease the opposition. However, Senator Laurel asserted the importance of reading the original and unexpurgated edition of Rizal's novels because the true purpose of studying these will be defeated if not followed.

To add a more conciliating clause, the last amendment was proposed the provisions regarding the exemption of students from reading the two novels on certain conditions. With this, on May 12, 1956, Senate Bill No. 438 was unanimously approved on second reading. The Lower House imitated the Senate and May 14, 1956, the bill was approved unanimously in the House of Representatives.

The trial of the Rizal Law in Congress (Senate and House of Representatives) is clearly a triumph of democracy. On one hand, the role of the opponents should not be overlooked because of the criticism they received. On June 12, 1956, President Ramon Magsaysay signed the bill to make it a law, thus giving birth to Republic Act 1425 also known as the Rizal Law. Below is a copy of the law:

REPUBLIC ACT NO. 1425

AN ACT TO INCLUDE IN THE CURRICULA OF ALL PUBLIC AND PRIVATE SCHOOLS COLLEGES AND UNIVERSITIES COURSES ON THE LIFE, WORKS AND WRITINGS OF JOSE RIZAL PARTICULARLY HIS NOVELS NOLI ME TANGERE AND EL FILIBUSTERISMO, AUTHORIZING THE PRINTING AND DISTRIBUTION THEREOF, AND FOR OTHER PURPOSES

WHEREAS, today, more than any other period of our history, there is a need for a rededication to the ideals of freedom and nationalism for which our heroes lived and died;

WHEREAS, it is meet that in honoring them, particularly the national hero and patriot, Jose Rizal, we remember with special fondness and devotion their lives and works that have shaped the national character;

WHEREAS, the life, works and writing of Jose Rizal, particularly his novels Noli Me Tangere and El Filibusterismo, are a constant and inspiring source of patriotism with which the minds of the youth, especially during their formative and decisive years in school, should be suffused;

WHEREAS, all educational institutions are under the supervision of, and subject to regulation by the State, and all schools are enjoined to develop moral character, personal discipline, civic conscience and to teach the duties of citizenship, Now, therefore,

Be it enacted by the Senate and House of Representatives of the Philippines in Congress assembled:

Section 1. Courses on the life, works and writings of Jose Rizal particularly his novel Noli Me Tangere and El Filibusterismo, shall be included in the curricula of all schools, colleges and universities, public or private: Provided. That in the collegiate courses, the original or unexpurgated editions of the Noli Me Tangere and El Filibusterismo or their English translations shall be used as basic texts.

The Board of National Education is hereby authorized and directed to adopt forthwith measures to implement and carry out the provisions of this Section, including the writing and printing of appropriate primers, readers and textbooks. The Board shall, within sixty (60) days from the effectivity of this Act, promulgate rules and regulations, including those of a disciplinary nature, to carry out and enforce the provisions of this Act. The Board shall promulgate rules and regulations providing for the exemption of students for reasons of religious belief stated in a sworn written statement, from the requirement of the provision contained in the second part of the first paragraph of this section; but not from taking the course provided for in the first part of said paragraph. Said rules and regulations shall take effect thirty (30) days after their publication in the Official Gazette.

Section 2. It shall be obligatory on all schools, colleges and universities to keep in their libraries an adequate number of copies of the original and unexpurgated editions of the Noli Me Tangere and El Filibusterismo, as well as of Rizal's other works and biography. The said unexpurgated editions of the Noli Me Tangere and El Filibusterismo or their translations in English as well as other writings of Rizal shall be included in the list of approved books for required reading in all public or private schools, colleges and universities.

The Board of National Education shall determine the adequacy of the number of books, depending upon the enrollment of the school, college or university.

Section 3. The Board of National Education shall cause the translation of the Noli Me Tangere and El Filibusterismo, as well as other writings of Jose Rizal into English, Tagalog and the principal Philippine dialects; cause them to be printed in cheap, popular editions, and cause them to be distributed, free of charge, to persons desiring to read them, through the Purok organizations and Barrio Councils throughout the country.

Section 4. Nothing in this Act shall be construed as amendment or repealing sector nine hundred twenty-seven of the Administrative Code, prohibiting the discussion of religious doctrines by public school teachers and other person engaged in any public school.

Section 5. The sum of three hundred thousand pesos is hereby authorized to appropriated out of any fund not otherwise appropriated in the National Treasury to carry the purposes of this Act.

Section 6. This Act shall take effect upon its approval.

Approved: June 12, 1956

LESSON 2

Concept of Hero

Lesson Outcomes:

At the end of the lesson, the students should be able to:

1. trace the Filipino concept of hero/bayani through times;
2. analyze the criteria set by the nation in recognizing heroes; and
3. assess the heroism of Rizal using the definitions and criteria of heroes.

Lesson Introduction:

People tend to misconstrue the title "hero" as an award given to dead people. Doing great things is great things is likewise misinterpreted as something only heroes, like Rizal, can achieve. Worse, as the popular Filipino adage "Mahirap magpakabayani. Ang bayani ay binabaril sa Luneta" implies, people become individualistic, devoid of care for others. Such views, unfortunately, hinder their sights on the various possibilities they can do for the country. This lesson traces the concept of hero in the Filipino culture and history to assess

whether its traditional sense is confined only to the likes of Rizal, on one hand, or may be applied to normal people, like the "millennials," on the other one hand.



Lesson Discussion:

Concept of Hero in Filipino Culture and History

One may notice the limited approach in the definition of the word "hero" in traditional western dictionaries. Hero is normally defined here as an illustrious man, often of divine descent, or with distinguished valor or enterprise in danger, and fortitude in suffering, who is supposed to be exalted after death. Being an extraordinary person and individualistic is apparent. This may be seen in the synonym of hero in Microsoft word "Superman."

The Filipino concept of hero, on the other hand, is a much broader concept, albeit stripped of grandeur. Known as Bayani, Bagani, Magani, or Wani in various Filipino ethno-linguistic groups, a hero in early Philippine societies was just a normal warrior of the community. His simple tasks were based on daily needs of the village. Pangangayaw or raiding into unallied territory is an example of this. According to William Henry Scott, pangangayaw was done because of four reasons, namely:

- 1) to secure resources, ranging from the occasional use goods or bounty to human slaves,
- 2) to avenge a personal affront or family honor;

- 3) to fulfil mourning requirements to which the life of enemies must be sacrificed, and lastly
- 4) for personal prominence or a mercenary reward.

It is important to point out that a Bayani does not work alone; he or she always exerts efforts together with his/her comrades in the community. Hence, the root word of Bayani is bayan (community/town/nation). When pangangayaw is done, the group of Bayani returns home; thus, fulfilling what Zeus Salazar said about the bayani as a person who leaves his/her town and then returns. The tattoo, used as the protection of kaluluwa (soul) of a Bayani, his kris/kampilan (weapon), his putong (head gear), and other garments colored red are his iconic physical features.

It is noteworthy to mention, however, that early Filipino heroes were neither savages nor blood-thirsty killing machines. A Bayani is more often than not a true kawani or lingkod-bayan (community servant) who renders his or her help to those in need in the community without counting the cost. His/Her ultimate goal is to maintain peace and order. The concept of bayanihan (cooperation) and the word ipabayani (free labor offered to/by someone) proves the semantic essence of Bayani.

The characteristics of early Filipino heroes are worth emulating. The Boxer Codex (1590), an ancient document about the early Philippine societies, defines a Bavani as a person with a high status and dignity. Pedro Serrano Laktaw, in his dictionary, elaborates the personality of a Bayani: a person who fears no one (walang-takot), courageous (matapang), firm (matibay), bold (mapangahas), but quiet (tahimik) and calm (mahinahon). Qualities of the main characters of Philippine Tuwaang, etc., on the other hand, represent the actual Bayani. All these qualities are clearly present in a living human. The concept of a Filipino Hero in early Philippine societies, therefore, is not a posthumous award given to dead people, but rather an honorific role and title in the society.

Nevertheless, changes occurred when the Spaniards conquered the Philippines. Instead of living role models, the Spaniards had introduced the image of obedience of saints and disciples whom the Filipinos had to imitate in order to become good colonials. Vida Sancti, or the lives of [dead] saints became the foundation of good qualities of life. Doctrina Christiana or prayer and faith.

The Americans, on the other hand, propagated a secular view on heroes. Heroworshipping of American soldiers who died during the Philippine-American War (then dubbed as Philippine Insurrection) like Gen. Henry W. Lawton, Col. John M. Stotsenburg, and Col. Harry Egbert, was promoted through monuments and annual commemoration rituals to justify the need for American tutelage in the Philippines.

Filipino heroes were also venerated during this period, Jose Rizal, who was executed by the Spaniards, became the leading national hero. Mabini, Luna, and Del Pilar also became household names. The problem to the new approach was that it coincides with the thrust of the Americans to instill to the minds of Filipinos the American culture. This was done through the study of American heroes and past presidents like George Washington, Abraham Lincoln, and Benjamin Franklin.

A modern-day concept of the indigenous Bayani still exists today. The Overseas Filipino Workers (OFW) are considered Bagong Bayani (new heroes). Their work abroad is said to be a continuation of the culture of pangangayaw. The word namayani, meaning to prevail or triumph, has become well-known. The concept of the Bayani is indeed embedded in the blueprint of Filipino well-being.

Criteria for Recognizing Heroes

A hero is a social construct. Since that is the nature of the process, recognizing heroes is always subjective. To bridge the gap, the National Historical Commission the Philippines

(NHCP) released some of the criteria for recognizing heroes, through their Project Saysay. The criteria are listed below:

1. the extent of a person's sacrifice for the welfare of the country (Teodoro A Agoncillo 1965);
2. the motive and methods employed in the attainment of the ideal (welfare of the country) (Teodoro A. Agoncillo 1965);
3. the moral character of the person concerned (Teodoro A. Agoncillo 1965);
4. the influence of the person concerned on his/her age and or the succeeding age (Teodoro Agoncillo 1965);
5. those who have a concept of nation and thereafter aspire and struggle for n's freedom (Onofre D. Corpuz 1993);
6. those who define and contribute to a system of life of freedom and order for a nation (Onofre D. Corpuz 1993);
7. those who contribute to the quality of life and destiny of a nation (Onore Corpuz 1993),
8. a part of the people's expression (Alfredo Lagmay 1995);
9. person who thinks of the future, especially the future generations Lagmay 1995); and
10. the choice of a hero involves not only the recounting of an episode in history, but of the entire process that made this particular per (Alfredo Lagmay 1995).

Rizal as a Filipino Hero



Jose Rizal as a Filipino hero is statesponsored through the Republic Act 1425 (Rizal Law). His heroism, however, is not a post-World War II phenomenon. Two years after Rizal's death, the first commemoration was held on December 30, 1898 when the then President of the First Philippine Republic, Emilio Aguinaldo, declared in Malolos, Bulacan, a day of National Mourning. Various provinces like Tayabas and Batangas were reported to observe the solemn commemoration in front of Rizal's portrait. But this was not the start of the long years of veneration. It is documented that during the meetings of the Katipunan, a portrait of Rizal was hanging in the room where members were made to believe that Rizal was an honorary member of the secret society.

The Americans, realizing the possibilities of a Rizal cult in their colonial agenda, seized the opportunity and made Rizal the "national hero of the Philippines. Among the choices they had, three criteria were used in the selection:

- 1) a hero who is not violent and militant, and if possible, preferred peaceful means like education;
- 2) a hero who had no qualms on American imperialism; and
- 3) a hero who is already dead.

It is obvious here that Del Pilar, Mabini, Bonifacio, and Aguinaldo were not qualified as heroes. It is a no-brainer that the Americans would pick Rizal ahead of others. In 1901, William H. Taft, President of the Second Philippine Commission, had appointed Rizal to embody the brand of nationalism propagated by the American colonial government.

However, there was no actual law during the American Regime that explicitly declared Rizal the official hero of the country. Three steps, instead, were made by the government to promote his heroism, namely:



- 1) the creation of Rizal Province;
- 2) the erection of Rizal Monument, and
- 3) the declaration of Rizal Day on December 30 as a public holiday.





Since then, Rizal's image as a hero of the Philippines has become a viable enterprise for stamp, chart, post-card makers, and other printed materials. This was heightened when in 1956, the Rizal Law was conceived, since books, textbooks, and modules were necessary for educational purposes.

In 1995, amidst the preparation of the nation for the upcoming centennial celebration of Philippine Revolution and Philippine Independence Day, the National Heroes Committee created by President Fidel V. Ramos released a list of recommended national heroes.

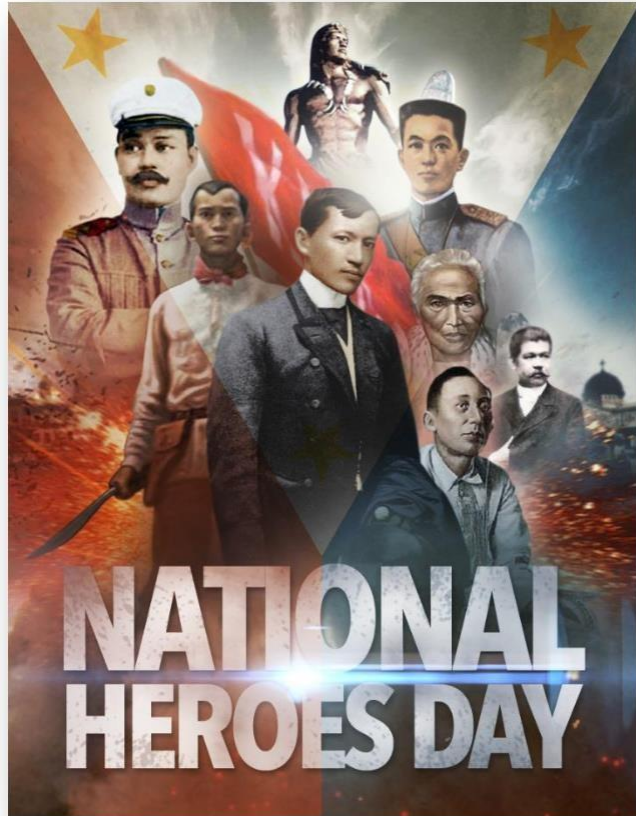
These were as follows:

- | | |
|-------------------------|----------------------------|
| 1. Jose Rizal | 6. Sultan Dipatuan Kudarat |
| 2. Andres Bonifacio | 7. Juan Luna |
| 3. Emilio Aguinaldo | 8. Melchora Aquino |
| 4. Apolinario Mabini | 9. Gabriela Silang |
| 5. Marcelo H. del Pilar | |

The aforementioned list is not yet approved. The website of the National Commission on the Culture and Arts states that "this might trigger a flood of requests for proclamations" and might "trigger bitter debates involving historical controversies about the heroes."

Various laws honoring/commemorating Filipino historical figures were instead passed into law.

Today, there are four major national celebrations with Rizal as an important subject: June 12 (Independence Day), June 19 (Birth Anniversary), last week of August (National Heroes Week), and December 30 (Rizal Day).



LESSON 3

Rizal as a Symbol

Lesson Outcomes:

At the end of the lesson, the students should be able to:

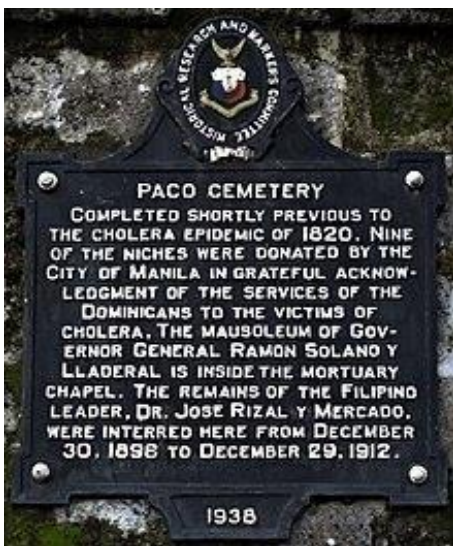
1. differentiate the historical Rizal from the symbolic Rizal;
2. analyze photos of Rizal as signs and symbols, and
3. assess the significance of symbols in strengthening national solidarity and sense of community.

Lesson Introduction:

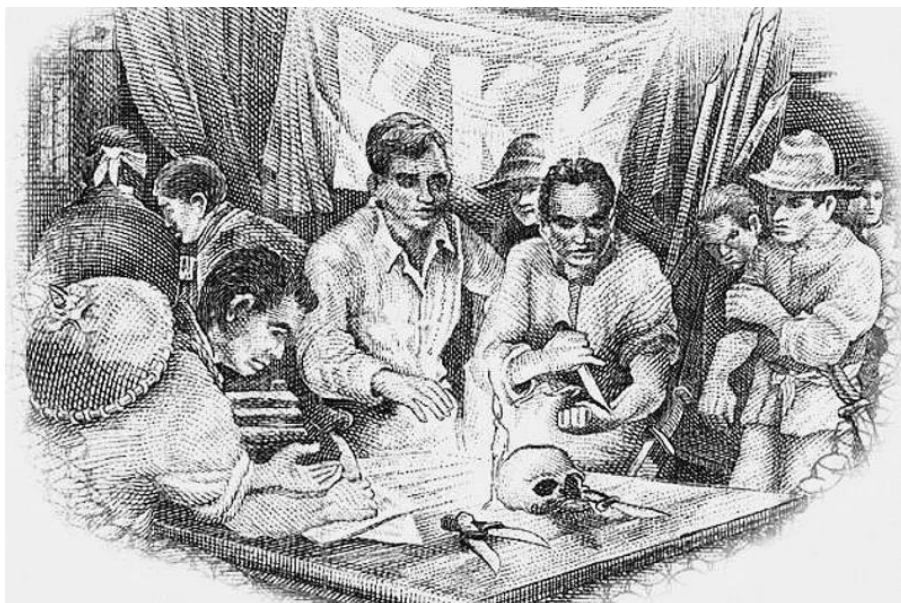
The readers of Rizal are said to be more powerful than Rizal himself. He lived and died in the past, but readers make him exist. Readers can actually manipulate his image depending on a specific agenda. The proliferation of ideas had indeed generated a "kanya-kanyang Rizal." This lesson will focus on the symbolic Rizal which in reality is the kind of Rizal we see in our daily lives. It is expected in the end that the "Millennials" would generate their own version of a symbolic Rizal.

Lesson Discussion:

When Jose Rizal was set to face his execution, he left a dying wish to his family. According to him, he should be buried in the earth, preferably in Paang Bundok (now North Cemetery) with a stone and a cross on top. His name, date of birth, and death must also be indicated. If possible, he requested for a fence that would mark his grave. He then stressed that no anniversary celebration must be conducted.



Nothing has been achieved in his last will. He preferred to be buried in Paang Bundok but he was buried first in Paco Cemetery and later transferred beneath his monument in Luneta on December 30, 1912. He requested a stone marker; instead, the nation granted him a grand stone monument. It is true that his final resting place is surrounded by a fence, but such fence is not in a grave, but in a big park which became a tourist spot for travellers and meeting place for lovers. Most of all, the whole nation commemorates his death every year with full military honors.



This is not the first instance the icon of Rizal was subjected to manipulation of other people. Oftentimes during the meetings of Katipunan, his portrait was hung on the walls of the meeting room so that members would see his face clearly. This was because Andres Bonifacio made Rizal the honorary president of the secret society. Debates may trigger controversies with regard to the true intention of the

Supremo; but one thing is for sure, Rizal was considered a symbol by many Filipinos.

So it was evident then that "two Rizals" appeared in the course of our history. The first one is the Historic Rizal who lived and died in the 19th century Philippines.

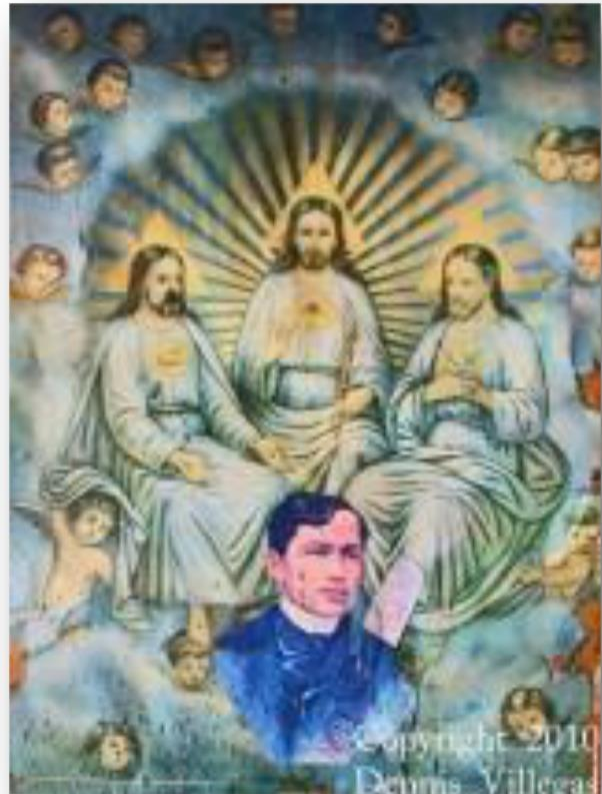
He is the Rizal born and raised in Calamba, Laguna, who studied at the Ateneo Municipal in Manila, travelled and studied abroad, published *Noli Me Tangere* and *El Filibusterismo*, founded the La Liga Filipina and the Martyr of Bagumbayan in 1896. He was the true person, the actual Rizal we can read in History books.

The Symbolic Rizal is the "second" Rizal. He is the kind of Rizal we have today. He is the Rizal in Luneta, the Rizal in the one peso coin, the Rizal in postage stamps, the Rizal as Tagalog Christ, the Rizal as an icon of Rock, the Rizal in t-shirts, and the list goes on. This kind of Rizal has indeed become a text open to many meanings.



To further elaborate, a text is anything that can be read, interpreted, and analyzed. The key concept here is reading. Reading is making sense of the world and our lives, we read spaces, places, our historical circumstances, and a plethora of images unleashed by the media, literature, and art.

Text has no intrinsic value or meaning apart from readers. The message it contains in the virtual/potential state is actualized by the reader. Its meaning is an effect of the reader's interpretation rather than a product of its author.



There are two types of text. The first one is sign. It is a kind of text which represents a fixed reality and posits itself as a means of portraying that reality. As in the words of Umberto Eco, a sign is a "closed" text which implies that the freedom to create meaning is being monopolized. For Roland Barthes, a sign is a readerly text, which can be understood as a kind of text whose meaning is predetermined; the reader is merely a site to receive information. Examples of signs are the Peso sign and slippery when wet road sign.

On the other hand, a text can be a symbol which conveys meaning not only about itself but about cultural processes and relationships; meaning, therefore that it is not constant but constituted through a human agency.

In the words of Umberto Eco, a symbol is an "open" text which implies that any interpretation may be valid. For Roland Barthes, a symbol is a writerly text, meaning that the reader is in a position of control and takes an active role in the construction of meaning. The reader is turned into a writer. Examples of symbols are the photos below:

LESSON 4



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in turn has a direct correlation to building the nation. This lesson aims to point out the role of Jose Rizal in today's process of nation-building.

Lesson Discussion:

Philippine History is a repository of the nation's collective memory. It should not be seen as a mere subject waiting to be memorized by students. It should be taken from the heart. Like breathing out and breathing in, studying History should be second nature to all Filipinos. This is the reason why History is translated in Filipino as Kasaysayan. Its root word is SAYSAY (essence). The narrative of the past must be seen as vital to their existence.

Likewise, studying the life, works, and writing of Rizal must be well entrenched in every Filipino's soul. Lessons about his life, like his education, lovers, past time etc. are all useless if not applied in real life. The same idea can be seen in the logic behind the annual commemoration of Rizal Day. How many among the youth truly imbibe the essence of Rizal Day? Rizal Day is not just a non-working public holiday to serve as an opportunity to stroll around malls, swim in beaches, and watch movies on Netflix. It is an opportunity for everyone to fulfill what Gemino Abad referred to the crucial infinitives in life "to read, to think, to write." Just like what Rizal did in past, everyone is enjoined to participate in political and social processes of building the nation, not necessarily great things right away but in small yet impactful. Especially the youth, they are expected to be "Rizal-like" in terms of deep nationalism.

MIDTERM PERIOD

CHAPTER II #RizalLife

Chapter Description:

This chapter introduces students to Rizal's life specifically his context. In studying the context of a certain individual or historic event, one must take into consideration the time, place, and the people or the overarching ideas present during the time in question. Rizal lived in the late 19th century, a time when various reforms were being implemented in the country. The situation of the Philippines, however, was not as inclusive and the gap between the rich and the poor created a tense atmosphere that eventually created nationalistic activities and organizations like the propaganda movement in Spain and the revolutionary movement (KKK) in the Philippines. It is important for students to know the events during Rizal's time, the places that he visited, as well as the people and ideas that he encountered to further understand the formation of Rizal's personality and consciousness.

Chapter Outcomes:

At the end of the chapter, the students should be able to:

1. appreciate how Rizal's context influenced the development of his consciousness;
2. relate how the different events in the 19th century as well as the different ideas he encountered during his travels were translated to his works; and 3.
3. assess the importance of one's context in the formation of one's character.

LESSON 5

19 th Century Philippines

Lesson Outcomes:

At the end of the lesson, the students should be able to:

1. discuss important changes in Spain and in the Philippines,
2. enumerate the policies that enabled Filipinos to organize and ask for reforms; and
3. relate how the conditions of the 19th century Philippines and Europe affected the formation of Rizal's consciousness.

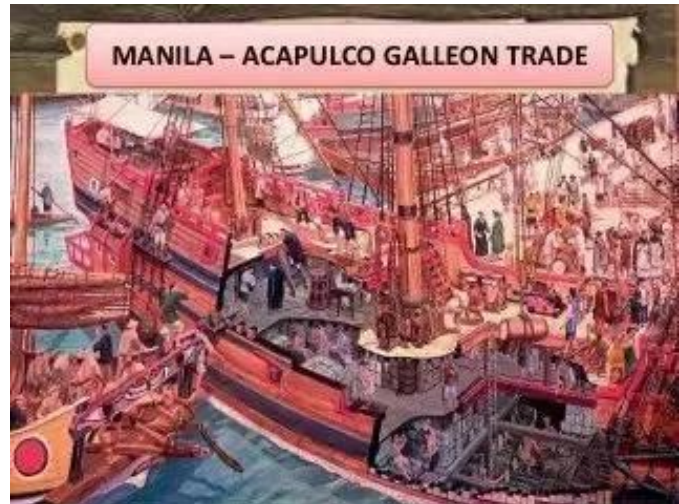
Lesson Introduction:

The late 18th and the early 19th century marked the beginning of the Industrial Revolution led by the British. Through the development of steam engines and the integration of machinery in production, Britain experienced rapid development and urbanization. While other countries were quick to emulate British industrialization, Spain lagged behind its neighbors mainly because of its engagements with the Napoleonic and Carlist Wars and the internal power struggle between liberal and conservative factions in Spain during the early 19th century. These changes in Spain eventually affected its relations towards its colonies and the Philippines experienced liberal policies and reform for the first time. This lesson explores the political and economic situation of the Philippines during the 19th century to further contextualize the life and times of Dr. Jose Rizal.

Lesson Discussion:

Economic and Political Situation of the Philippines

Some historians refer to the 19th century as a long century in Philippine history because of the numerous changes that happened during this period. In terms of political and economic changes, the brief occupation of Manila by British forces in 1762-1764 and the rapid development of economies in Europe made Spanish administrators in the colony rethink their policies so as not to get left behind by their neighbors and to prevent another incident such as the British occupation from happening again in the near future.



Some of the more notable reforms were the abolition of the Galleon trade and the opening of the Philippines to world trade in 1830. This enabled not only the increase in economic activities in the country and the entry of firms from other European states, but also the entry of foreign ideas mostly through the form of books and other printed media during that time. In the case of Rizal, he was able to read various European literatures such as Alexander Dumas' *The Count of Monte Cristo* and *The Three Musketeers*. Andres Bonifacio, the leader of the *Kataas-taasan, Kagalang-galangang Katipunan ng mga Anak ng Bayan* (KKK), was also able to read literatures on the French revolution that later on influenced some of the works of both individuals.



The end of Spain's wars with the Dutch and the British, as well as the nullification of the slave raiding activities of the Moro, also led to the development of agricultural lands and the discovery of new frontiers in the Philippines. This eventually created a change in the social and economic class in the country with the principalias and mestizos benefitting from these changes, thus the consequent emergence of local elites. In Laguna, Jose Rizal's family was considered to be one of the local elites in the province since they were leasing large blocks of lands from friar estates in Calamba.

These developments however did not help in bridging the gap between the local elites and the poor and marginalized sectors in the country. This gap led to different revolts such as the Basi Revolts in Ilocos Sur and Ilocos Norte during the early 19th century. These revolts showed the growing gap between the rich and the poor because they were directed not only against the Spanish authorities but also to the babaknangs or elites in the two provinces. The implementation of the Cadiz Constitution in 1812 also provided a brief legal justification for the quest for equality since it was stated in the document that all citizens of Spain, including those in the colonies, were equal under the law.

In Southern Tagalog areas, brigandage and tulisanes increased their robbing kidnapping, and pillaging activities, prompting the colonial government to create the Guardia Civil in 1868.

Some movements such as the Cofradia de San Jose in Tayabas, Quezon, on the other hand, had more religious overtones that challenged the dominance of the Catholic Church and the discrimination between the religious orders and secular priests.

Education and the Rise of the Ilustrados

But through all these reforms, perhaps the most notable was the increase of educated Filipinos as the colonial government, under directives from Spain, also started to reform educational institutions in the Philippines. Filipino and Chinese Mestizo elite families who were able to capitalize on the opening of the Philippine markets to the world sent their children to school to take professional courses not only in the Philippines but also in Europe. Travelling to Europe during that time was also made easier with the opening of the Suez Canal in 1859. With their education and exposure outside the country, these individuals, who later on were referred to as ilustrados, eventually formed the core of a new emerging movement that asked the colonial government for much needed reforms in the Philippines.

This new movement, called the reform and propaganda movement, was different



from earlier revolts because it had a more nationalistic and racial dimension fueled by the sufferings and discriminations experienced by Filipinos under the Spaniards. This was also supplemented by the liberal policies applied by liberal administrations of Spain in the Philippines such as the Cadiz Constitution in 1812.

This movement also drew inspiration from the earlier efforts of the native secular priests such as Padre Jose Burgos who fought for equal rights among the clergy in the 1860's. The secular priests' move, along with the students' involvement from different higher institutions in the country during that time, to gain equal rights, however, was interpreted by the Spanish administrators and friars as an attempt to overthrow the government leading to massive breakdowns made against students along with some local elites in the country in 1872. Burgos, along with fathers Jacinto Zamora and Mariano Gomez, were executed on February 17, 1872.



Rizal was born in 1861 amidst all of these political and economic reforms and turmoils. He belonged to a local elite family who was fortunate enough to capitalize on the existing conditions at the time. He was sent to school in the Philippines, and despite the hardships that his family had to go through during the latter part of the century, he was able to study in Europe. Rizal actively participated in the propaganda movement while he was studying in Europe.

Later on, he moved back to the Philippines in 1892 establishing the La Liga Filipina, Rizal's involvement in the revolution is still a controversial issue among historians today,

with some arguing that Rizal was not in favor of the revolution; while others see Rizal being one of the main influences of the KKK.



Two things are for sure, however. First is that Rizal also thought about revolution as a means of emancipating the Philippines from Spain based on his letters to fellow propagandists and friends such as Jose Alejandrino, Antonio Luna, Marcelo H. Del Pilar, and Ferdinand Blumentritt. Second is that the founders of Katipunan, like Andres Bonifacio and Deodato Arellano, were members of Rizal's La Liga Filipina.

LESSON 6

Memorias de un Estudiante de Manila

Lesson Outcomes:

At the end of the lesson, the students should be able to:

1. explore important aspects of Rizal's childhood from his *Memorias de un Estudiante de Manila*;
2. identify relevant individuals and institutions instrumental to his education; and
3. appreciate Rizal's view on childhood, family, love, and education

Lesson Introduction:

Rizal, under the pen name P. Jacinto, wrote his own memoirs of his experiences as a student from Binan to Manila in 1872. This is a valuable document because it is Rizal's own recollection and is a primary source regarding his childhood days. Reading through the document provides insight to Rizal's sentiments towards love and family, as well as to the importance of education.

Lesson Discussion:

Rizal wrote his memoirs from 1872 to 1911. composed of 8 chapters spanning his childhood to his days as a student in Manila. A full translation of the document was made by the Jose Rizal National Centennial Commission and is available in various sources including books and online websites. Chapter 1 of the document highlights Rizal's childhood in Calamba providing a personal description of the place including their house and their lifestyle. Another notable event in the first chapter is the death of Concha, (Rizal's sister) for whom Rizal shed his first tears.



Chapter 2 documents Rizal's first time away from home when he was sent to study in Binan, Laguna, as well as his daily routines as a student. This chapter is full of Rizal's longing for his family and his hometown. Chapter 3 is Rizal's memories of the events that transpired between the years 1871 and 1872 particularly his mother's case. This event really devastated Rizal since his mother was taken away and imprisoned, leaving them without guidance.

In Chapters 4 and 5, Rizal recounts his time as a student in Manila especially at the Ateneo de Municipal. In here, he states the different rules implemented by Ateneo to ensure the competitiveness of its students, as well as the different books that he read, which influenced his own writing. An example is Alexanre Dumas' *The Count of Monte Cristo* that became influential to his writing of *El Filibusterismo*.

Chapter 6 is dedicated to Segunda Katigbak, Rizal's first love. Rizal, however remembers this period of his life with bitterness. They were both young and Segunda was already engaged to someone else when they met. There were no significant events in Chapter 7.

In the final chapter, Rizal recalls the tale of the lamp. This story is very important since it captures Rizal's symbolic representation of the light. From the translation of the Rizal National Centennial Commission.



My mother began to read to me the fable of the young and the old moths, translating it to me piece by piece in Tagalog. At the first verses, my attention redoubled in such a way that I looked towards the light and fixed my attention on the moths that fluttered around it. The story could not have been more opportune.

My mother emphasized and commented a great deal on the warnings of the old moth and directed them to me as if to tell me that these applied to me. I listened to her and what a rare phenomenon the light seemed to me more beautiful each time, the flame brighter, and I even envied instinctively the fate of those insects that played so



cheerfully in its magical exhalation. Those that have succumbed were drowned in the oil; they didn't frighten me.

My mother continued her reading, I listened anxiously, and the fate of the two insects interested me intensely. The light agitated its golden tongue on one side, a singed moth in one of its movements fell into the oil, clapped its wings for some time and died.

That assumed for me that the flame and the moths were moving far away, very far, and that my mother's voice acquired a strange, sepulchral timbre.

My mother finished the fable. I was not listening, all my attention, all my mind, and all my thoughts were concentrated on the fate of that moth, young, dead, full of illusions. "You see?" my mother said to me taking me to bed. "Don't imitate the young moth and don't be disobedient; you'll get burned like it." I don't know if I replied, promised something, or cried. The only thing I remember is that it took me a long time before I could sleep. That story had revealed to me things unknown to me until then.

To me, moths ceased to be insignificant insects; moths talked and knew how to warn and advise as well as my mother did. The light seemed to be more beautiful, dazzling, attractive. I understand why moths fluttered around lights. Advice and warnings resounded feebly in my ears. What preoccupied me most was the death of the imprudent, but at the bottom of my heart, I didn't blame it. My mother's solicitude didn't have all the success that she hoped it would. No; many years have elapsed; the child has become a man; has plowed the most famous foreign rivers, and meditated besides their copious streams.

The steamship has taken him across the seas and all the oceans; he has climbed the region of perpetual snow on mountains very much higher than the Makiling of his province. From experience he has received bitter lessons, oh, infinitely more than the sweet lesson that his mother gave him, and nevertheless the man preserves the heart of a child and he believes that light is the most beautiful thing there is in creation and that is worthy for a man to sacrifice his life for it.



LESSON 7

Influences

Lesson Outcomes:

At the end of the lesson, the students should be able to:

4. Identify individuals relevant to the formation of Rizal's consciousness as a student in the Philippines and in Europe;
5. define the different disciplines and ideas encountered by Rizal through his exposure to different academic circles in Europe and
6. assess how these ideas influenced his writings and his stance regarding the emancipation of the Philippines.

Lesson Introduction:

It is important to note that Rizal would have never grown up to be who he was without the people whom he met throughout his life. This lesson introduces students to the different individuals who were crucial to the formation of Rizal's ideas and his character starting with his family, the Propaganda Movement, academic organizations in Europe, as well as the people of Calamba.

Lesson Discussion:

Rizal's Family

Donya Teodora can be considered as Rizal's first teacher. In *Memorias de un Estudiante de Manila*, Rizal looked up to her as the one who influenced his love for learning as shown by their nightly readings in their house in Calamba.



Saturnina Rizal



Narcisa Rizal



Olympia Rizal



Lucia Rizal



Maria Rizal



Concepcion Rizal



Josefa Rizal



Trinidad Rizal



Soledad Rizal

In *Letters to the Women of Malolos*, Rizal even recognized the importance of mothers in inculcating this value to their children along with the love for country as they are the first teachers of their children, at least in the traditional family setting.

Next to Donya Teodora is his brother Paciano, whom he recognized as the noblest of all Filipinos in one of his letters to Blumentritt. Paciano was responsible for relaying the message of secularization especially the ideas for reform from Padre Jose Burgos, one of the martyrs who were executed in Bagong Bayan in 1972 after being accused of playing a part in the Cavite Mutiny.

As a Student in Binan and Manila

Rizal was also home-schooled before he was transferred to a private school in Binan, Laguna, which was under the supervision of Justiniano Aquino Cruz. His love for painting was nurtured early on by an old painter named Juancho in Binan. He stayed there for one and a half year.



From 1872-1877, Rizal studied in Ateneo de Manila under the supervision of Jesuit priests. Jesuit education was characterized by rigid discipline and Rizal appreciated his time under Fr. Francisco de Paula Sanchez who inspired him to study harder and write poetry. He was also able to meet Fr. Jose Villalara who encouraged Rizal to study philosophy and the natural sciences. Rizal graduated with a degree of Bachelor of

Arts. He also completed a vocational course on surveying in the same school.

From 1877-1882, before his first trip to Europe to study ophthalmology, Rizal enrolled at the University of Sto. Tomas to pursue his medical studies. Before taking up medical studies, however, Rizal took up a course on Philosophy and Letters for a year.

In 1882, he was sent to Europe by his brother Paciano with the secret mission to observe the life, culture, languages and customs, industries and commerce, and governments and laws of different European countries. Rizal enrolled at the Universidad Central de Madrid on November 8, 1882. While studying medicine, he also studied French, German, and English at the Academy of Fine Arts of San Fernando, and fencing and shooting at the Hall of Arms of Sanz y Carbonell.

Rizal in Europe: German Scholarship

During his time in Europe, Rizal also benefited from the development of Orientalist studies in Germany. His involvement in German scholarship can be traced to his connections with Ferdinand Blumentritt, an Austrian scholar who published books about Philippine ethnological topics. Resil Mojares, in his article Rizal Readine Pigafetta from his book Waiting for Mariang Makiling: Essays in Philippine Cultural History, enumerated the different scholars whom Rizal met through the help of Ferdinand Blumentritt:

4. Hendrik Kern - professor of Sanskrit at the University of Leiden:
5. A.B. Meyer-director of the Ethnographic Museum in Dresden

6. Wilhelm Joest - pro pest - professor at the University of Berlin who also published articles about the Philippines;

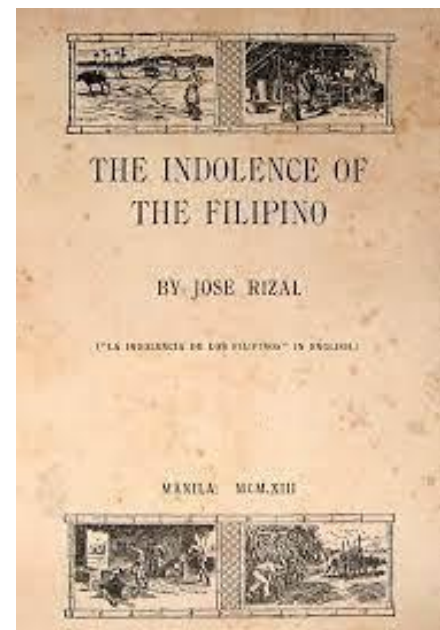
5. Fedor Jagor - a naturalist who travelled to Southeast Asia; and

6. Rudolf Virchow -president of the Berlin Society for Anthropology, Ethnology, and Prehistory.

Aside from these individuals, Rizal was also able to associate himself with academic organizations in Germany such as the Geographical Society in Berlin and the Anthropological Society founded by Rudolf Virchow and Adolf Bastian in the 1880's. Through his association with German scholars, he was able to immerse himself in the potential of the social sciences especially the discipline of history in studying the Filipino past, culture, and identity. On April 13, 1887, he wrote Blumentritt and mentioned his (Rizal's) objective of establishing a Philippine studies subject or course as a way for Filipinos to know themselves.

With the necessary methodological, conceptual, and theoretical tools, Rizal pursued his personal researches about the Philippine past. During his second sojourn to Europe, he read various archival materials about the Philippines especially at the British Museum. He read the accounts of Spanish missionary reports, travel books to the Philippines and Southeast Asia, and Chinese records from 13th to 14th century. Some of the notable works he produced in the social sciences were his annotations of *Sucesos de Las Islas Filipinas* by Antonio de Morga, *The Indolence of the Filipinos*, and his planned organization *Association Internationale des Philippinistes* that aimed to organize different conferences about the Philippines with History as a central theme.

Through his conceptualization of the *Association Internationale de Philippinistes* and his planned conference, Rizal divided Philippine history into three periods namely: precolonial Philippines, the loss of Philippine Autonomy from 1521 to 1808 and finally from 1808 to the Cavite Mutiny in 1872. Historians today refer to this type of periodization as the Tripartite View of Philippine history.



During the formation of the revolutionary movement under Andres Bonifacio the Katipuneros also incorporated the tripartite view in the KKK's initiation process giving it a more revolutionary and localized character by calling the pre-colonial period as Liwanag, the Spanish colonial period as Dilim, and the period of liberation from Spain as Muling Liwanag, Prospective members of the Katipunan had to memorize this before they were accepted in the group.

Rizal's Scholarship, the Propaganda Movement, and the Suffering of the Filipinos



Rizal's being a doctor also greatly influenced his writing and analysis of the situation of the Philippines. It was evident in his discussions about the Philippines in his essay. The Indolence of the Filipinos where he frequently referred to the country as a body that could experience sickness and decay, but could also be healed. In *El Filibusterismo* Chapter 7 with the title, Simoun and Basilio, Simoun debated whether he would simply do his part as a professional or engage actively in treating the social ills infecting the country.

Of course, the Propaganda movement in Spain also influenced Rizal especially with the establishment of *La Solidaridad* in 1889. Rizal actively participated in asking for reforms and in writing articles for the *Soli*.

However, most of his ilustrado contemporaries were not as interested as he was in writing about the Philippines, and this greatly frustrated Rizal who wanted his fellow Filipinos to devote more effort and time towards researching about the country. Because of internal politics and the incident in Calamba from 1887 to 1888, Rizal eventually dissociated himself with the reform movement and took on a more radical stance regarding the emancipation of the country.

This led us to perhaps one of the greatest influences in Rizal's life—the suffering of Filipino people under Spain. Rizal had always been emphatic about the situation of his

countrymen and it grew exponentially when the people of his town, including his family, were unjustly persecuted. This can also be shown with Rizal's break-up with the propaganda movement-more than the internal politics within the group, his main motivation why he no longer saw himself pushing for reforms was the sufferings experienced by the tenants of Calamba and his family.



PROPAGANDA MOVEMENT (1872 – 1892)

LESSON 8

Rizal, the Polymath

Lesson Outcomes:

At the end of the lesson, the students should be able to:

4. identify different disciplines and interests of Jose Rizal:
5. explore a new skill or a new field of study, and
6. relate how learning new skills and exploring new fields can be beneficial for the welfare of the community and the country.

Lesson Introduction:

Rizal, in all aspects, was a true scholar. He enjoyed learning from different fields, whether from the arts or the sciences. He never limited his capacity to learn; he emphasized the importance of education for the Filipinos. This lesson aims to highlight Rizal's education, as well as other fields that he explored as a scholar.

Lesson Discussion:

Rizal's Interests, Skills, and Talents

Rizal studied to become a doctor specializing in ophthalmology. However, he never let his profession limit what he could do as an individual. Aside from being a doctor, he was also known among his peers as a prolific writer and he would always be remembered because of his two novels, *Noli Me Tangere* and *El Filibusterismo*. He was also trained in the social sciences during his time in Germany in 1889.

Some scholars attribute Rizal's versatility to his being a genius. The term genius, however, is still a debatable term with others measuring it quantitatively through the level of Intelligence Quotient or IQ; while others measure it quantitatively through an individual's contributions to society. Regardless of how we measure ingenuity, it is clear

that Rizal was a remarkable individual based on his credentials and his contributions to society.

First, Rizal graduated with high honors when he was studying in Ateneo. He also consistently had high grades when he was attending school in different universities in the Philippines and abroad. He was also a dedicated scholar who used his spare time studying other languages and subjects, as well as other arts, such as poetry, sculpture, painting, and martial arts specifically fencing. It was said that Rizal was one of the best practitioners of fencing among ilustrados during their time in Europe.

Also, while we honor Rizal as the doctor and the writer, most of his scientific works were done during his exile in Dapitan from 1892-1896, when he conducted numerous scientific works that involved collecting and sending different animal specimens to Blumentritt. He also conducted business ventures, improved the water system in Dapitan using his background in land surveying, established a school where he taught arithmetic, writing, geography, and history to young boys in Dapitan. In his spare time, he created various art works, and conducted various ethnographic, linguistic, and geographical studies in Mindanao. When he won a lottery on September 21, 1892, he used the money to buy 16 hectares of land in Talisay, Dapitan where he also practiced his farming skills.

He did all of these activities while serving also as an ophthalmologist that eventually led to the romance between Rizal and Josephine Bracken, who one day brought her blind father, Mr. George Taufer, to Rizal for a medical consultation.

In retrospect, 1892-1896 can be considered as one of the golden ages of Dapitan because of the help of Dr. Jose Rizal. He engaged in different community projects that boosted the economy and quality of life in the area. He also remained true to his vow to educate the Filipinos by establishing a school in Dapitan. Whether he was a genius or not by today's standards, Rizal embodied his vision of a true scholar and citizen in the service of his country. Rizal was a model of consistency when he said that the ilustrados in Europe must go back and serve in the Philippines. In fact, he himself came back in 1892 despite the dangers he faced in the Philippines, even when he enjoyed a relatively comfortable and safe life as an ophthalmologist in Hong Kong in 1891. He made sure that even in exile, he used all of his abilities and talents to serve his countrymen.



SEMI-FINALS PERIOD

CHAPTER III

#RIZALWorks

Chapter Description:

In this chapter, we are going to explore Rizal's different fields of Interest, from his well-known writings, views on science and his scientific undertakings, artistic and creative pursuits, and eventually to the creation of an organization. Every great man and woman capable of expressing his/her thoughts is endowed with a vision to purport his/her ideas unto another. This was how Rizal transformed his deep knowledge on the things surrounding him. In dealing with his writings, he came up with numerous essays, poems, letters, and novels to substantiate the different facets of his time. When it came to complex sciences, a topic which unwelcome back then in Spanish colonial Philippines, Rizal went to discover its advantages and made full use of them in dealing with the indolent situation of the country. Along with his rational knowledge was also his pursuit for the creative. The creative faculties of his brain determined the importance of not only the rational but also the visual. To create art is to inform others without explaining too much. His artistic pursuit gave way to express his deepest thoughts along with his poetry. The culmination of all his efforts was best displayed in his facilitating the possibility of Filipinos working together. As he worked on uniting all the people in the archipelago, Rizal dealt with centuries of divisive thinking or regionalism and political bickering by other less attenuated individuals. He nonetheless came victorious in providing the inspiration for a national organization.

Chapter Outcomes:

At the end of the chapter, the students should be able to:

1. enumerate the different works, Interests, and organizations of Dr. Jose Rizal;
2. discuss how Rizal valued the arts and the sciences in his works; and
3. analyze the different disciplines he ventured in and how it shaped his mind for the birth of a nation.

LESSON 9

Works of Rizal

Lesson Outcomes:

At the end of the lesson, the students should be able to:

4. discuss selected works of Rizal:
5. enumerate the significance of each of his works in their own context; and
6. relate the significance of Rizal's works to one's life.

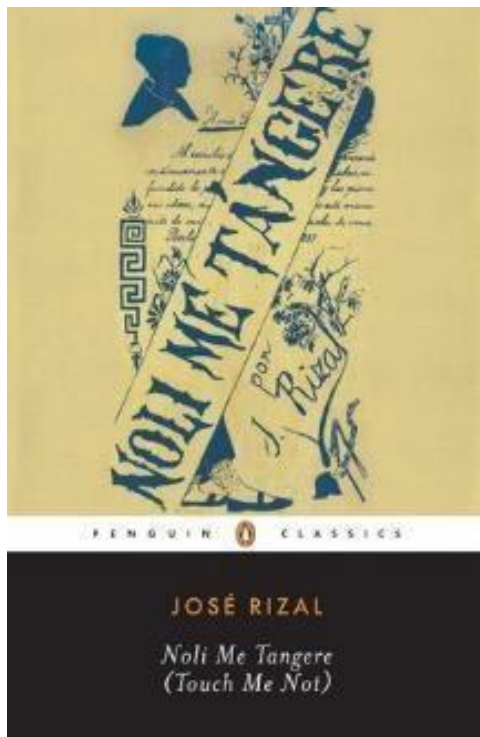
Lesson Introduction:

In this lesson, we take a closer look at how Rizal used his talent for writing in reaching a great number of people. From his life as a young student up to his final days in Intramuros, Rizal always had his pen beside him.

This lesson aims to position the student with regard to Rizal's selected works in their specific contexts, along with the important concepts found in each one.

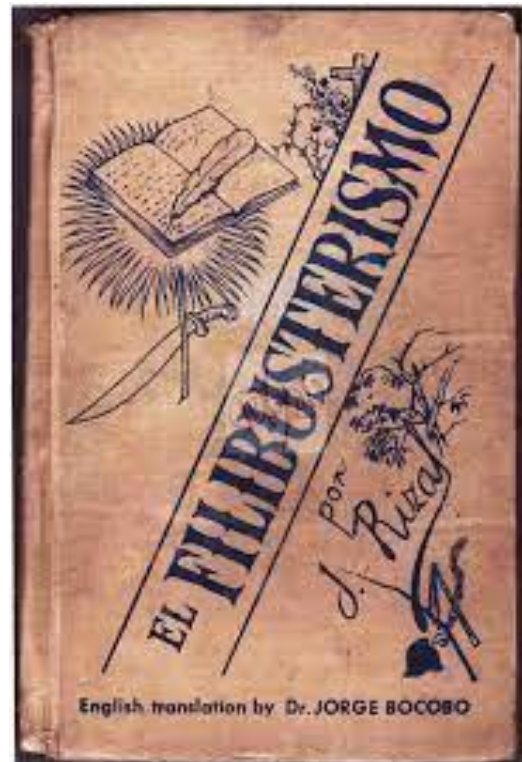
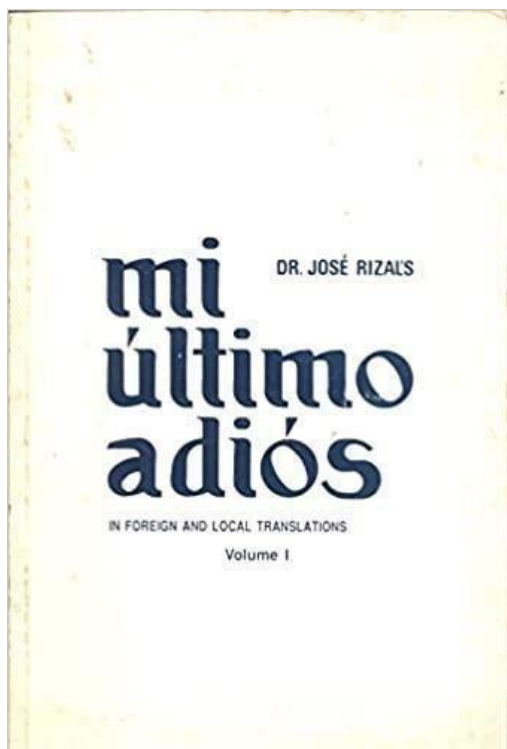
Lesson Discussion:

A man of letters, Rizal is known best for his writings. His novels were the reasons for sparking a revolution. He was also a man who wrote a lot to his friends, family, colleagues, fellow reformers, and many more. Aside from all the prose he became she also produced fine poems expressing the deepest desires of his hearts that no essay, letter, or novel could materialize.



The *Noli Me Tangere*, a Latin phrase for "touch me not," came out in 1887, published in Berlin, Germany. It was his first attempt to talk about his people while revealing the social ills and complications a fellow Filipino like himself would have to live with during the Spanish rule. Eventually, this became a massive hit, it became his masterpiece. With the lens of a doctor, he tried to expose the ills of society and looked for proper remedy. As a mere novelist and physician, he applied his knowledge of prescription by means of exposing the evils in society. Rizal intended to bring enlightenment to his readers. Those readers in turn became doctors themselves to the malady as each held knowledge vital to its cure or detriment.

In his second novel, the *El Filibusterismo*, a Spanish term for 'The Subversion', came out in 1887, published in Ghent, Belgium. Continuing where he left off with a new cast of characters, Rizal explored the Philippines in a much grander scale. Both these two novels depicted the life of the colony, detailing the various characters in their own context while drawing inspiration from real life contemporaries.



In one of his poems, *Mi Ultimo Adios* (My Last Farewell in English) he bid adieu to his beloved country. Well hidden in the lamp given to Trinidad on the eve of his martyrdom, Rizal spoke in English so as to cleverly tell his dear sister as to the tents inside. Later this letter was translated by the Supremo Bonifacio in Tagalog as *Pahimakas ni Dr. Jose Rizal*, that further sparked the cause to revolt, stirring the emotion of the people.

Regardless of a number of his influential works, some of his writings also employed greater skill as a scholar of various disciplines. As a student of history, Rizal

notated the known book of Antonio de Morga's *Sucesos de las Islas Filipinas*. His method of annotation was by hand which made him spend a lot of time in the British Museum where one of the extant copies was located.

LESSON 10

The Value of Science

Lesson Outcomes:

At the end of the lesson, the students should be able to:

4. enumerate the discoveries made by Rizal in Dapitan;
5. provide alternative ways on looking at how his mind works; and
6. synthesize his scientific approach to framing a nation

Lesson Introduction:

Science was instrumental in the developing changes in the 19th century. Rizal was also a part of that century when various methods of enlightening took shape not only in the societal arena but also in industrial concerns.

In this lesson, we take a further look into the state of science in the Philippines back in Rizal's time and how he viewed its contribution to the nation he envisioned.

Lesson Discussion:

Science was not at the forefront of the Spanish colonial Philippines in the 19th century. It was merely introduced as a required subject to be taken to fulfill the much needed courses to attain a degree. The *El Filibusterismo* described a student enrolled in a class of Physics to be "reciting lessons from memory," which was a usual predicament back then. Students were to mimic, like parrots, the lessons laid out by their professors from the religious orders.

When students showed a sign of distaste for the subject, the atmosphere transformed into "a sermon about lessons on humility, submissiveness, and respect for the religious." That was the context by which science was suppressed in the 19th century. But in one of his essays, the *Religiosity of the Filipinas*, Rizal asserted that science is helpful in understanding the Creator.

As a propagandist writing in the *La Solidaridad*, Rizal would invoke the importance of science in laying out reforms and in improving the state of the country. In the *Indolence of the Filipinos*, Rizal argued the important use of physical sciences to understand current social reality. In *The Philippines a Century Hence*, he compared science with history.

"History does not record in its annals any lasting domination by a group of people...the existence of a foreign body within another endowed with Strength and activity is contrary to all natural and ethical laws. Science teaches us that it is either assimilated, destroys the organism, is eliminated or becomes encysted."

An ardent admirer of the physical sciences, Rizal had to prove his knowledge about the subject when he was in exile in Dapitan. The solitude and tranquility of the place provided him with resplendent natural surroundings and he believed that any scientific pursuit would be within his grasp. In his four-year exile, he fostered fascination for conchology or the study or collection of shells, estimated to be around 346 shells from 203 species. Rizal became a familiar name for at least three species named after him: *Draco rizali* (lizard), *Apogonia rizali* (beetle), and *Rhacophorus rizali* (frog). Furthermore, he delved into archaeological, geological, geographical and anthropological studies based on his correspondences with his fellow scientists.

Rizal was also in touch with his scientific side and never relinquished his thirst for knowledge.

The species named after him clearly displayed his contributions to botany and zoology. His inquiries into the local environment provided detailed accounts of his different contributions to society. A man of his caliber, born in the East, educated in the West, and still was able to focus and look on the greater side of man makes you take a second look on his scientific pursuits.

LESSON 11

The Art of Rizal

Lesson Outcomes:

At the end of the lesson, the students should be able to:

4. identify the artistic works of Rizal and how he made use of them,
5. establish the connection of his art works with other fields of endeavor; and
6. synthesize Rizal's passion for the arts complementing his love for reason

Lesson Introduction:

Most of the works of Rizal are glossed over by historians. But when they look at his humanity, creativity, and expression, they would be surprised, for he was also an artist!

In this lesson, we deal with the side of Rizal being a creator of his designs, literally. As he was managing to travel abroad, correspond with distant family and friends, or mark a special occasion for a person or event, his creative hands could not help but accentuate his thoughts. Finally, a closer look into the different types of his art works is discussed in this lesson.

Lesson Discussion:

Rizal utilized his knowledge of the arts and its power of evoking what words cannot describe. This talent of Rizal provided an added fuel in sending out his message and

connecting to the people close to him as if they were just near. The understanding that Rizal also knew of the arts casts another look at his creativity.

Rizal was a fan of the visual arts. His pen being famous for writing so many lines, people tend to forget about its other use for conjuring up an image. He had the talent for it even at a young age. He was said to have been given clay and moments later he fashioned it into a tiny sculpture. He was given creative freedom by his parents at a very young age. If Rizal were to be given another chance in life, he would have chosen to be an artist. But, alas, it was not to be. Instead, he used this skill in providing joy to the people around him.

By sharing his talent in crafting something out of nothing, Rizal provided his circle with the benefit of being complete. As he was narrating his travels abroad, he also attached a sketch of a view from his steamer or apartment.

Lesson 11: The Art of Rizal | SEMI-FINAL

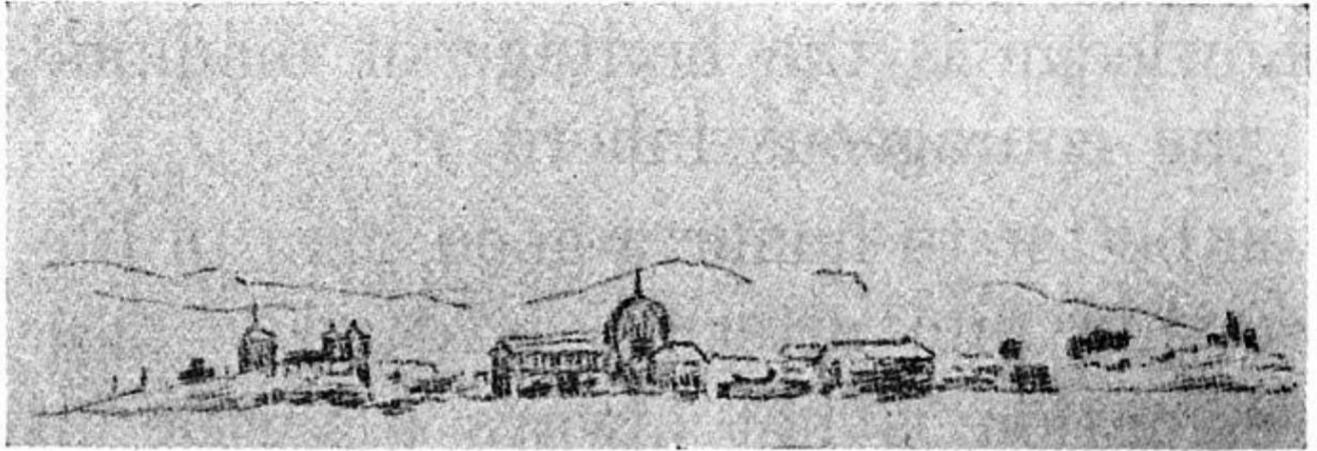
In most cases, he would send some of his friends some letters with an attachment along with these on special occasions. When he felt gloomy or wanted to report to his correspondence about the State of his health, he would often take a selfportrait about

There were cases also of giving tokens of appreciation in the form of a small portrait bust in exchange for the hosts' hospitality and warmth. At times, his skills would be used to carve out toys for the games he invented as well. One of the most famous would be his artistic cover of his first novel, *Noli Me Tangere*. It was a teaser of sorts to the uninitiated contents of his book, giving glimpses of details about characters and elements in various chapters.

He also gave time to be playful and came up with his version of a comic strip for his nephews in the *Monkey and the Turtle*. Yet even those dear to his heart need not worry, for he was truly inspired by them and drew their portraits as a souvenir. The variety and extent of Rizal's artistic practice was indeed diverse!



himself and would narrate the state he was in.



A sketch of himself by Rizal,
in the training class.



LESSON 12

Organizations

Lesson Outcomes:

At the end of the lesson, the students should be able to:

7. categorize the different organizations that Rizal had formed; 8. discuss the reason for establishing each organization, and
9. classify each organization's specific contribution.

Lesson Introduction:

If one plans to change something impossible, he must be in the company of a few, for in this few, he gathers the strength of the many. Trusted and like-minded individuals such as Rizal were constantly looking for people who would be willing to accompany him in his greater goal. In his studies abroad, he became open to establish various organizations who would be a larger voice in hearing out the faint cry of the people. This lesson deals with the different organizations Rizal became involved in.

Lesson Discussion:

Upon his arrival in Europe, Rizal linked up with his fellow Filipinos. They established a number of organizations to strengthen their identity as a simple collective group of Filipinos embarking on the Paris Exposition of 1899. They adopted the name of Kidlat Club, whose members included Antonio Luna, Baldomero Roxas, Fernando Canon, Juan Luna, etc. Eventually, the name became temporal, fashioned out of a whim. However, they spotted the native American Indians and were inspired by them. From being kidlat Club, they became the Los Indios Bravos. Adopting the derogatory term, the Spaniards called their fellow Filipinos, the members classified themselves into a greater goal of unifying their fellow Filipino students in Europe.

Eventually, this group of students and young professionals became entrenched in providing a voice to air their issues and suggestions to the government. The Asosacion

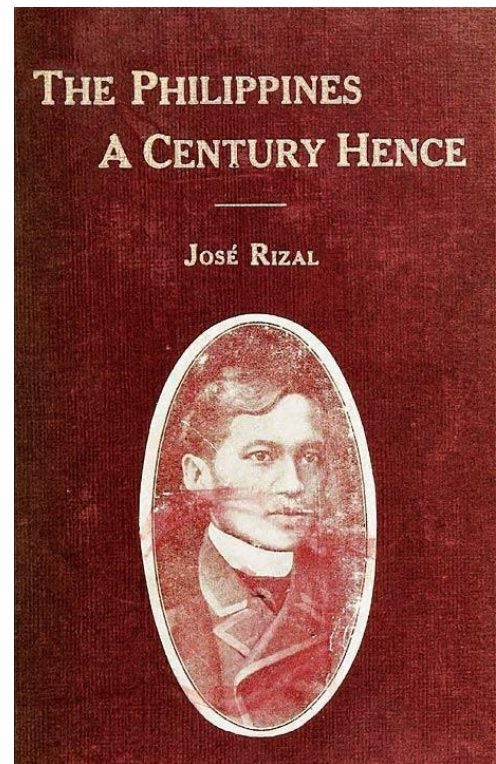
La Solidaridad materialized. This organization later published the newsletter entitled La Solidaridad where the lengthiest and groundbreaking articles of Rizal were published, the 5-part Indolence of the Filipinos and Philippines, A Century Hence.

"Man works for an object. Remove the object and you reduce him to inaction. The most active man in the world will fold his arms from the instant he understands that it is madness to bestir himself, that this work will be the cause of his trouble, that for him it will be the cause of vexations at home and of the pirate's greed abroad." Indolence of the Filipinos (Part III)

"Deprive a man, then, of his dignity, and you not only deprive him of his moral strength but you also make him useless even for those who wish

to make use of him. Every creature has its stimulus, its mainspring: man's is his self-esteem. Take it away from him and he is a corpse, and he who seeks activity in a corpse will encounter only worms." Indolence of the Filipinos (Part IV).

"No one ceases to be a man, no one forfeits his rights to civilization merely by being more or less uncultured, and since the Filipino is regarded as a fit citizen when he is asked to pay taxes or shed his blood to defend the fatherland why must this fitness be denied him when the question arises of granting him some right? Moreover, how is he to be held responsible for his ignorance, when it is



acknowledged by all, friends and enemies that his zeal for learning is so great that even before the coming of the Spaniards every one could read and write..."
Philippines, A Century Hence (Part III).

"The people no longer have confidence in its former protectors, now its exploiters and executioners. The masks have fallen. It has been that the love and piety of the past have come to resemble the devotion of a nurse, who, unable to live elsewhere, desires the eternal infancy, eternal weakness, the child in order to go on drawing her wages and existing at its expense, it has seen not only that she does not nourish it to make it grow but that she poisons it to stunt its growth and at the slightest protest she flies into a rage!"
Philippines, A Century Hence (Part II).

"Perhaps the great American Republic, whose interests lie in the Pacific and who has no hand in the spoliation of Africa, may dream some day of foreign possession. This is not impossible, for the example is contagious, covetousness and ambition are among the strongest vices, and Harrison manifested something of this sort in the Samoan question... Furthermore, this is contrary to her traditions." Philippines, A Century Hence (Part IV).

When he returned to Manila, Rizal tried to establish the first national organization uniting the archipelago. Never before had there been a gathering where different mestizos and indios were unified under one country, the Filipinas. On the 3rd of July, 1892, Rizal established his national organization at the Ongjunco Residence, in Tondo, Manila. It was to be known as the La Liga Filipina. It was attended by a number of Filipinos from different fields and social strata like Domingo Franco, Pedro Serrano Laktaw, Ambrosio Salvador, Apolinario Mabini, Andres Bonifacio, and several others.

The La Liga Filipina had its own constitution written by Rizal. Its aims were the following:

7. unity of the whole archipelago into one compact and homogenous body;
8. mutual protection in every want and necessity;
9. defense against all violence and injustice;
10. encouragement of education, agriculture, and commerce; and
11. analysis and application of reforms.

Eventually, the La Liga Filipina was the last organization Rizal formed and was directly involved in because a few days after, Governor General Despujol arranged for Rizal's arrest and eventual exile to the southern part of Mindanao, Dapitan. Despite his failure to materialize any long standing organization, Rizal's followers were able to establish for themselves without his help. The formation of the Katipunan by Supremo Andres Bonifacio who benefited from Rizal's Vision made use of the latter's influential mien, as references alluding to the Dapitan exile was present throughout their secret organization.

FINALS PERIOD

CHAPTER IV

#RIZALPatriotism and Nationalism

Chapter Description:

Rizal was a central figure who laid the foundation for the creation of the Filipino Nation. Through his writings, he emphasized the need for an educated and active citizenry that included everyone especially the youth and the women. An active citizenry is crucial to the identification and healing of different social ills that hamper the progress of the nation. This chapter explores the core ideas of Rizal especially those relating to progress, education, leadership, and the nation. It is through these ideas that Rizal remains relevant to the country and to its people today.

Chapter Outcomes:

At the end of the chapter, students should be able to:

7. display greater appreciation to education, women, leadership, and national progress;
8. discuss the different ideas that Rizal wanted to emphasize in his works; and
9. apply Rizal's ideas as students and citizens of the Philippines

LESSON 13

Rizal's Tripartite View of History

Lesson Outcomes:

At the end of the lesson, the students should be able to:

7. compare and contrast the concepts of the Bipartite and Tripartite View of History;
8. analyze Rizal's perspective on Philippine History; and
9. use History to address current issues.

Lesson Introduction:

Rizal, in his annotation to Antonio de Morga's *Sucesos de las islas Filipinas*, said that "to foretell the destiny of a nation, it is necessary to open a book that tells of her past." Uttered in his time, Rizal hoped to influence the nation's future through the use of the narratives of the past. Such threefold approach became the foundation of his nationalist project when he returned to Europe.

This lesson tackles Jose Rizal's vision of Philippine History and aims to remind the youth about the significance of history in our lives.

Lesson Discussion:

Bipartite vs. Tripartite View of History

Jose Rizal's personal experience of unequal treatment conferred to fellow folks in Calamba regarding land dispute in 1887 served as his last straw of faith to the colonial regime. He had already reached the point of conclusion that the Philippines had no future if it remained a colony of Spain. Thus, his transformation of consciousness had come to full circle at the onset of his second sojourn to Europe (1888-1892). Rizal now had a clear mission-to imagine a separate Filipino nation. To do this, Rizal sought historical scholarship to destroy the evils of Spanish colonialism.

Rizal, however, was not the first of his kind. There were efforts to combat colonialism using history by other Filipinos before him. Fr. Jose Burgos, the leading icon of the secularization movement and whose works greatly influenced Rizal championed this, though inaccurate in most of his historical accounts, Isabelo de los Reyes, a notable Filipino journalist, had written volumes of newspaper articles on Philippine history; albeit relegated to limited value only by his contemporaries. The infamous Pedro Paterno, the architect of the Truce of Biak-na-Bato in 1898. also devoted his life while in Madrid, Spain, venturing on historical writing; but his works were merely showing the sameness of the Spanish and Filipino culture prior to colonization. Nevertheless, all these proved the growing interests of Filipinos to defend themselves through past narratives.

Such Filipino approach alarmed the Spaniards and propelled them to revive the old colonial myth of lazy natives, a belief on the indolence of Filipinos as the root cause of societal stagnation in the Philippines. This was backed up by another colonial ideology of "ingrate Filipinos who entertained the prospect of expelling the friars and the possibility of a separate Filipino nation in the 19th century. The fundamental thesis was to blame the natives for their barbarism and stupidity, which in turn resulted to general backwardness. Guardians of the empire were mostly friars and apologists, like Barrantes, Retana, and Quioquiap, who relentlessly criticized Filipinos for their ingratitude to Mother Spain.

The perspective utilized by the Spaniards is known today in Philippine History Historiography as the Bipartite View of History. It refers to the biased vision of colonialist to their colony to justify the perpetuation of colonial status quo. It can be easily understood by this twofold framework: DARKNESS-LIGHT (DILIM-LIWANAG). Darkness here is metaphorically pertaining to backwardness, while light means civilization. In the context of Spanish colonialism, it advances the idea that the Philippines had no civilization (Kadiliman) before the advent of Spanish colonialism. But when the Spaniards conquered the archipelago, civilization (Liwanaag) came afterwards.

The opposing concept of the view explained earlier is the Tripartite View of History. It refers to the idea of the colonial subjects against their colonizers to deny the nobility of colonialism. The threefold framework is LIGHT-DARKNESS-LIGHT (LIWANAGDILIM-MULING LIWANAG). The approach centers on how 300 years of Spanish rule in the Philippines ruined the advanced civilization of early Filipinos and the possibility of returning to their glorious years when colonialism is eliminated.

The Tripartite View of History preoccupied the minds of many Filipino Mustrados who studied in Europe in the 19th century. Propagating it, however, was not the endgame as it appeared only to be throwing stones at each other. Telling the Spaniards that they

ruined the Philippines was insufficient because it would only be branded as accusations and black propaganda. What the Filipinos needed that time were solid evidence that could rival the more dominant views expressed by colonial sentinels.

Rizal's contribution to historical writing arrived in the nick of time. His massive research and accurate historical method laid the foundation of Philippine historiography. He did this through mastering the technique he learned from Europe, and applied this in his 1890 edition of Antonio de Morga's *Sucesos de las islas Filipinas*.

Rizal's Annotation to Antonio de Morga's *Sucesos de las Islas Filipinas*

Rizal had been contemplating on a well-written history of the Philippines when he finished his first novel in 1887. But he was too reluctant at first because of his lack of resources. Instead, he implored his friend Ferdinand Blumentritt to write the history of the Philippines due to his apparent expertise on the subject matter, to which the latter refused. Realizing that his plea did not stand a chance, Rizal decided to do it by himself in his own way. Instead of writing an entire book dedicated to the country's history, he rather resorted to annotating a previously published Philippine history book-the book entitled *Sucesos de las Islas Filipinas* written by Antonio de Morga.

Antonio de Morga was a Seville-born statesman who joined the Spanish government in 1580. In 1593, he was appointed Lieutenant-Governor of Spain's colony in the Philippines, the second in command next to the Governor-General. In 1598, he assumed the position of Oidor, or judge in the Audiencia. In 1600, he led the Spanish troops against Dutch invaders led by Oliver van Noort; but he lost in this battle. This defeat paved the way for his relief in position and transfer to Mexico, where he published his book *Sucesos de las Islas Filipinas* in 1609.

Rizal, after getting permission from friends and authorities, devoted his time and laboriously conducted his intensive research at the British Museum in London for four months (September to December of 1889), where he found the original manuscript of *Sucesos*. As technology was not yet advanced during his time, he patiently hand copied the entire book. He also dared to read other chronicles about the Philippines (those written by Pigafetta, Chirino, Colin, Gaspar de San Agustin, Combes, etc.) and compared them to Morga's narrative to see which accounts corroborated. His comments can be found in the footnotes of his edition.

Important questions beg for answers. First, among the history books written and published, why did Rizal choose the work of Morga? The answer lies in the background and personality of the author:

5) Morga saw the transition of periods from early Philippine societies to colonial Philippines; hence, he was an eyewitness, so his accounts were more reliable compared to other narratives; and

6) Morga was not a member of religious congregations (Jesuits, Dominicans, Franciscans, etc.) so his accounts were secular in nature. It is not to say that religious accounts were not credible; it was just that chronicles of friars might not be considered history in its modern concept.

The second question is, what are the contributions of Rizal's annotation to Morga's *Sucesos*? The historian Floro Quibyen provides the answers:

11. Rizal's scholarship was based on German historiography which utilizes modern historical method;
12. Rizal's research into the past was intended as a basis for critiquing colonialism as well as for defining (or constructing) a Filipino national identity;
13. Rizal made a stronger claim for viewing national identity within Asian Pacific perspective; and
14. Rizal's work had impact on nationalist movement, particularly to Bonifacio's Katipunan.

Rizal, overall, just wanted to use the words of early Spaniards to refute the thesis of colonial apologists of his time. In his introduction, he said that:

If the book succeeds to awaken your consciousness of the past, already effaced from your memory, and to rectify what has been falsified and slandered, then I have not worked in vain, and with this as a basis, however small it may be, we shall be able to study the future.

Jose Rizal
Europe (1889)

Below are excerpts from Rizal's 1890 edition of Antonio de Morga's *Sucesos de las Islas Filipinas*:

Throughout these Islands are certain places where there is an abundance of rich gold deposits and other mineral products which are collected by the natives through washing or placer-mining. However, after the Spaniards had settled in the island, the natives became laxer in mining gold, contenting themselves with what they already had in the form of jewelry and ancient ingots of gold, inherited from their forebears, which were abundant in themselves. In fact, poor and indigent was indeed one who did not possess gold-chains, bracelets and earrings (260).

Rizal's Annotation:

The Indios on seeing the wealth aroused the capacity of the encomenderos and soldiers, abandoned the work in the mines, and priest-historians relate that, in order to save them from vexations, they recommended to them such procedures.

LESSON 14

Rizal and Education

Lesson Outcomes:

At the end of the lesson, students should be able to:

- 4) identify the different works of Rizal that showed his perception on the importance of education in the country: 5) create their own career plans for the future; and
- 6) discuss how their chosen careers may help in the improvement of life in the Philippines.

Lesson Introduction:

Despite the numerous works written by Rizal, he consistently emphasized the importance of education in his works. While historians are torn between Rizal's stance on revolution and reform, historians do agree that the education of the Filipino people was his top priority from the moment he participated in the Propaganda movement in Spain, his short stay in Dapitan, until his last days in Fort Santiago.

This lesson aims to encourage students to follow Rizal's footsteps and prioritize education as a key to becoming a productive citizen of the Philippines.

Lesson Discussion:

Education in Rizal's Works

Educating the Filipinos is a common theme in most of Rizal's political writings. In *Noli Me Tangere*, the main character Crisostomo Ibarra wanted to build a school for his countrymen. As the story continued to the second novel, *El Filibusterismo*, Crisostomo Ibarra, who was seeking for revenge through his new identity Simoun, now had a more proactive view on education, stating that simple education was not enough. In Chapter 7, Simoun was unmasked by Basilio and they had a debate regarding the youth's role in easing the sufferings of the country. For Basilio, being a physician who cured physical illnesses was already enough. Simoun, however, emphasized the importance of curing not only the physical illnesses but also the social illnesses experienced by the country. Rizal, through Simoun, wanted students and professionals who are active in their chosen fields to be also involved in conversations

regarding the status of the nation and in trying to address these societal issues, Rizal basically wanted an educated and active citizenry.

When he returned in 1892 to establish the La Liga Filipina, one of the objectives of the organization was to encourage instruction (teaching), agriculture, and commerce. Even in the marginalized status of women, Rizal viewed education as a primary tool for their empowerment in a male-dominated colonial society. When Rizal was in he dedicated his time to the community for the education of the children by building a school in the area and acting as their teacher. He also continuously emphasized to his sisters the value of educating oneself by reading and grabbing every opportunity to learn. As an uncle, he also tried to inculcate these values to his nephews and nieces by translating Hans Christian Andersen's tales from German to cultivate their interest in reading.

Education as Revolution

Rizal also viewed education as a means to an end. In *Memorias de un Estudiante de Manila*, he used the fire to symbolize education. It was illuminating but the path towards it was dangerous and may eventually result to death. Looking back at Rizal's time, this representation of education was understandable since during the 1860's and the 1870's. Most Filipinos demanding for reforms were educated elites as well as native secular priests such as Padre Jose Burgos. The repressive colonial regime tagged students as destabilizers and there was a massive crackdown among intellectuals as well as their families especially after the Cavite Mutiny of 1872.

Tagging intellectuals as destabilizers continued through the 1880's and 1890's especially during the height of the propaganda movement in Europe. With Rizal as a central figure of the propaganda, he eventually became the main target of the colonial regime and was executed on December 31, 1896. In his *Memorias*, however, Rizal emphasized that though the road to enlightenment was harsh, every step of the way was worth everything.

In *El Filibusterismo*, Rizal continued this symbolism of education as fire. Simoun's planned revolution was supposed to be ignited by an explosion of a custom-built lamp bomb. The inventor of the bomb was a former teacher. It was Isagani, a youth who prevented the explosion and Simoun eventually failed in the end. Padre Florentino, in his last conversation with Simoun, stated that a revolution must be made for greater cause.

Rizal and Education

Finally, Rizal viewed education as something revolutionary, not in a subversive and violent sense, but in freeing the mind from the darkness and bonds of ignorance. A free mind however must be aware of the different issues of his or her society. He or she must be actively engaged in trying to change society for the better.

LESSON 15

The Role of the Youth

Lesson Outcomes:

At the end of the lesson, the students should be able to:

- 4) compare the various types of youth Rizal had to deal with;
- 5) identify the qualities of youth; and
- 6) relate how the youth is instrumental in nation building.

Lesson Description:

A famous saying goes, "Every generation believes it is greater than the one before it." The generation of Rizal was not exempted from this as well. People in Rizal's generation believed that they had the means and resources to travel, study abroad, and meet different people. Little did they know that their generation would become instrumental in the reforms and revolution at the end of the 19th century. They were old enough to have seen or indirectly learn about the martyrdom of the three priests, Father Mariano Gomez, Jose Burgos, and Jacinto Zamora. The role of the youth in finding out their place in society is undeniably instrumental in the formation of a nation as they grapple with their identities in the midst of numerous distractions they face.

This lesson looks into the youthful stage of Rizal and follows the development of how he devised the ideal image of the hope of the motherland.

Lesson Discussion:

In Europe, where they pursued greater studies, Rizal and his compatriots indulged in learning and a little pleasure from time to time. The primary reason for being there was to learn what Europe had to offer. From the various fields of arts, sciences, medicine,

engineering, and law, they never forgot to indulge in different pleasures such as women, operas, parties, and expositions. The convivialities of youth, where parents' hopes rested upon, were tested when it came to their rather conceived independence. Yet, not all of them became busy with the fancy; instead, a few kept their eyes on the goal. Rizal became one such beacon amidst the darkness, He occupied himself with his writings, studies, and even to a point of organization building. He thirsted for learning and his hunger to align himself with like-minded individuals made him to stay focused on the goal. It was during this time that he met his fellow reformers and even some of his fellow scholars in various universities.

In the last chapter of his second novel, *El Filibusterismo*, Rizal had a message to a specific group of people who held the key to the nation's future. It was from the lips of an old hermit of a priest, Padre Florentino, that Rizal evoked his longing for a generation that would open its minds to the realities of society. Padre Florentino cried out with the following lines:

"Where are the youth who will consecrate their golden hours, their illusions, and enthusiasm for the welfare of their country? Where are they would generously shed their blood to wash away so much shame, so much crime, so much abomination? Pure and spotless the victim has to be for the holocaust to be acceptable!... Where are you, youth, who toll incarnate in yourselves the vigor of life that has fled from our veins, the purity of ideas that have been soiled in our minds and the fire of enthusiasm that has been extinguished in our hearts?... We wait for you, O youth! Come, for we await you!"

The call from beyond the grave maybe a bit eerie; nonetheless, this call resonated throughout the past century. Rizal, immortalized in his novels, spoke to a generation of Filipinos to carry on the task of fulfilling their duty of improving the nation from their forebears. His standards of the youth as being pure and noble were for something worthy of the country,

Each moment the youth dreams; it must be for the good of the nation. They fulfill their duties to their parents by performing well in school and this is reflective not only of the grades received but also of the critical thinking they do. Doing their obligation as learners, moment by moment reflects their obedience to duties,

Every minute of their waking hour must be deliberate, aiming for something greater than them. They must not look at themselves with a sense of entitlement, but

rather with deep regard for others. As they look upon the state of their community, society, and nation, they see themselves as either a contributor to endless mayhem or a world changer much like what Rizal envisioned them to be.

For more than three centuries, Spain dominated the Philippines, producing subjects in their likeness. Rizal wanted to break free from that mindset. As Filipinos living in a democratic and sovereign nation now, the youth experiences and enjoys what Rizal did not. They are now benefitting from the struggle of their forebears and each must continue to deliver advancements for the nation.

LESSON 16

The Role of Women in Nation -building

Lesson Outcomes:

At the end of the lesson, the students should be able to:

4. discuss the role of women in nation building according to Rizal;
5. assess the status of women in the present society, and
6. formulate a project that shows the importance of gender inclusivity in society.

Lesson Introduction:

The Letter to the Women of Malolos is a central document when talking about Rizal and his views regarding the role of women in nation building. It was written in 1889 at the request of Marcelo H. Del Pilar to encourage the women in Malolos in their attempt to establish a night school.

Lesson Discussion:

The Women of Malolos

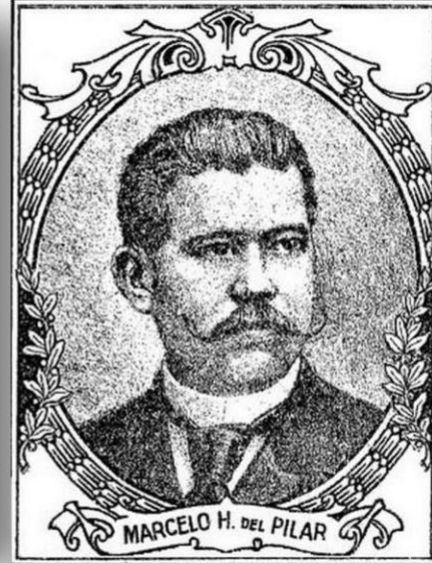
Rizal was popularly depicted a womanizer because of a long list of his ex-lovers. This depiction, however, fails to give him justice, for Rizal recognized the value of women especially in nation building, Rizal's letter to the women of Malolos is a work that showed his perception of the important role of women for emancipation of the nation.



As a brief background, the women of Malolos who belonged to Chinese-Mestizo clans in Bulacan namely the Tiongsons, Tantocos, Reyeses, and Santos, were actively involved in the quest for educational reform. They wanted to study Spanish under Teodoro Sandico and they personally gave their letter of request to then Governor General Valeriano Weyler on December 12, 1888. Learning Spanish meant that the women might now participate in social discourse since it was the language used in politics, Spanish friars during that time prohibited this attempt to learn to maintain control over women. Native priests in the Philippines, however, had always been supportive of the move to educate their fellow Filipinos, especially with the establishment of the Royal Decree of 1863 that aimed to educate all Filipinos, men and women, in Spanish. Yet, this was never realized since their Spanish counterparts did not allow the natives, especially the women, to learn the language. This was thought to aggravate the difficulties already faced by colonizers, adding to the problem of the colonial government's lack of teachers, funds, and schools to accommodate Filipinos.

Despite all the hindrances met by the women from Malolos, they never wavered; and by 1889, they finally got what they wanted, provided that they funded their own cation and that the classes were to be done at day and not at night. The school however was short-lived as Sandico was falsely accused of disseminating antigovernment ideas in his school in May, 1889.

The propaganda movement commended the women's brave attempt to educate themselves. Propagandists like Graciano Lopez Jaena and Marcelo H. del Pilar wrote them in *La Solidaridad*. Marcelo H. del Pilar was the one who requested Rizal obliged and on February 22, 1889, he sent del Pilar a letter written in Tagalog.



The Role of Women in Nation-building

The following are the major points raised by Rizal in the letter he wrote for the young women of Malolos.

First, he commended the bravery of the young women especially in their quest to educate themselves emphasizing the role of reason over blind obedience, and their continuous search for wisdom. Women's education is therefore one of the first prerequisites in empowering women in society and making them active citizens in the formation of the nation.

Second, in relation to education, he pointed out one of the most important roles of women, which was the raising of a child. As the first teachers of their children, at least in the traditional family settings, Rizal wanted the Filipino women to be the first to inculcate children with love for country and for learning. He used the Spartan woman as an example to illustrate this point.

Finally, Rizal stated the importance of high standards in finding a partner. Women must not settle for less and they must find partners who were equally patriotic, noble, and manly.

Women in Other Letters of Rizal

Aside from the letter to the women of Malolos, Rizal also emphasized the importance of women in some of his letters. Aside from his usual praise of how his mother taught them, he also continuously encouraged his sisters to pursue their education. For example, in a letter sent to his sister Soledad Rizal Mercado on June 6, 1890, as translated by A.P. Purino in the book *Rizal: The Greatest Filipino Hero*, Rizal wrote:

I am pleased to know that you are dedicating yourself to teaching because I believe that in that profession, you will be obliged to improve yourself more and more. Try to be a model of good virtue and good traits, in as much as the one who teaches ought to be better than the persons who need to learn virtues.

Rizal also appreciated the strong women of Germany. In another letter addressed to his sister Trinidad on March 11, 1886, as translated by Gregorio Zaide, the German woman according to Rizal:

...is serious, diligent, educated, and friendly. She is not gossipy, frivolous, and quarrelsome like the Spanish woman. She is not particular about the beautiful

dress and expensive jewelry, though she could dress nicely like any other woman in the world.

...Now that you (Trinidad) are still young you should strive to read, read, and learn. You must not allow yourself to be conquered by indolence because it costs so little to cast it off

Rizal's respect for women was cultivated through a strong women figure, Donya Teodora, who guided his childhood and through strong bonds with his sisters. Despite growing up in a patriarchal or male-centric society that dictated women as passive individuals limited to stay at home, Rizal knew that women must play a more crucial role in building the nation and to him, it had to start with their proper education.

LESSON 17

Leadership

Lesson Outcomes:

At the end of the lesson, the students should be able to:

4. identify the qualities of a leader according to Rizal;
5. explain the need for leadership roles in the face of challenges, and
6. relate the character of Rizal's leadership in today's society.

Lesson Introduction:

This lesson will familiarize students with Rizal's views on being a good leader. Based on his life and writings, we can determine what is needed to have a position worthy to be emulated.

Lesson Discussion:

Movements are fueled by one's desire for change and Rizal became a leader of a great movement. His passion was enlightening the minds of his fellow Filipinos. No matter how difficult it was, his mind was fixed on a much greater goal that he braved the different oceans and overcame all adversities be they in Madrid or Manila.

To become a leader, one must train and become an expert. As Rizal grew older, so did his intellectual capacity. He maintained this hunger for knowledge, devouring countless books on literature, history, sciences, and poetry among others. One essay he published reflected another view on Philippine history.

Contrary to the accepted notion of Filipinos being wild and uncivilized, he found answers in books, correcting the flawed notion. His love for books gave him an advantage over his peers. He even earned distinctions and medals when he was a student, all because he willed himself and believed that what he was doing was not for his sake but for the betterment of his country.

In every great leader are certain qualities. These qualities are of intelligence and foresight. Only then will his/her quality develop into his/her character. But in order to hone and have that character, he/she must be knowledgeable of the facts at hand. Rizal pursued different leads in his quest to find reliable evidence.

The substantial claims that early Filipinos were civilized were a big leap in understanding the cause of the malady of society as what he did in *The Indolence of the Filipinos*. However, in another great work, he tried to extrapolate the play of contradiction between the past and present while also giving an outline for the future. He suggested radical ways of investigating the malady, through the use of physical sciences, social determinism and the unity of opposites.

With the aid of the physical sciences, he was to predict the independence of the country. According to social determinism, abuses and oppression bred the flame of revolt, and eventual freedom and emancipation was also at hand. On the unity of opposites, the organic spirit began to disintegrate leading to its eventual salvation.

Many became leaders for stepping to the challenge ahead and Rizal was different. If it were not for the events in 1872, the martyrdom of Fathers Gomes Burgos and Zamora, for whom his second novel is dedicated, Rizal would not have been inspired to learn more about the ills of the country and looked for ways to combat them. As a physician by training this did not stop him from looking into all disciplines to express his thoughts and inspire others along the way.

LESSON 18

Rizal and the Philippine Revolution of 1896

Lesson Outcomes:

At the end of the lesson, the students should be able to:

1. compare the concept of reform and revolution;
2. analyze Rizal's views regarding the Philippine Revolution of 1896; and
3. apply the concept of revolutionary spirit in present-day issues.

Lesson Introduction:

We often hear Rizal's classical opinion on Philippine Revolution that the "Filipinos were not yet ready for armed resistance against Spain in 1896". Equally popular was the primacy Rizal gave to education. Likewise, Rizal allegedly indulged in reforms only and rejected revolution for an independent Filipino nation. These views, unfortunately, are perpetually passed on to future generations. Today we tend to make false dichotomies between the *lustrado* and Masses, vis-à-vis Reform vs. Revolution. We even make our heroes clash like chickens in a cockpit arena when we compare Rizal's pen and Bonifacio's bolo.

This lesson analyzes the concepts of reform and revolution to see if Rizal's views really contradicted the aspiration of the Philippine Revolution of 1896.

Lesson Discussion:

Rizal's Separatist Stance

Historian Renato Constantino, in his 1969 Rizal Day lecture, read his seminal article titled *Veneration without Understanding*. His main thesis centered on the repudiation of Philippines' national hero to the Revolution of 1896 led by Andres Bonifacio and participated in by the masses, as attested by Rizal's December 15, 1896 manifesto to a certain Filipino and Pio Valenzuela's prison testimony.

Constantino even accused Rizal as an American sponsored hero or a colonial hero who in spirit supported the prolongation of American Imperialism; and a limited hero who only advanced the interests of his fellow *Ilustrados*. Constantino went beyond boundaries by prescribing the nation to replace Rizal in the pantheon of heroes with a "true" hero, who embodies the hopes and desires of the people.

The critical tone Constantino popularized became etched in the minds of Filipinos for a long period of time. It actually became the standard critique on Rizal's heroism until recent works appeared conciliating the role of Rizal in the Philippine Revolution. Notable here was the work of Floro Quibuyen titled *A Nation Aborted: Rizal, American Hegemony, and Philippine Nationalism*. He vehemently accused Constantino and other writers who hastily and anachronistically studied Rizal. For Quibuyen, what was needed was careful reading of Rizal's correspondence, novels, essays, foundation of *La Liga Filipina*, and how *Katipuneros* and the Filipino masses in the 19th century perceived him.

With this, it is necessary to point out some of the factors that led to the radicalization of Jose Rizal. As early as 1887-1888, Rizal had already been entertaining the possibility of a separate Filipino Nation. In a letter to his friend Ferdinand Blumentritt, he stated that:

The Filipinos had long wished for Hispanization and they were wrong in aspiring for it. It is Spain and not the Philippines who ought to wish for the assimilation of the country.

(Rizal's Letter to Blumentritt on February 21, 1887)

The Calamba Hacienda Case, which was personally led by Rizal during his brief detour in the Philippines in 1887 and the events that followed it greatly influenced his

brewing separatist stance. The event on March 1, 1888, now known as the Manifestation of 1888, or what Historian Austin Coates considered the first public outcome of the influence of *Noli me Tangere* was the first to affect him. The incident involved the *gobnadorcillos* of Manila who appealed to the civil governor for the expulsion of friars in the Philippines. The petition was junked and as a response, those twenty-eight people who spearheaded the standoff were imprisoned. Rizal upon learning this, wrote to his friend Blumentritt and expressed his emotions:

I believe that it is already late; the majority of Filipinos have already lost the hope they have pinned on Spain! Now, we await our fate from God and from ourselves, but never any more from any Government!

(Rizal's Letter to Blumentritt on June 23, 1888)

The continuation of arrests which spanned from late March to early April 1889 also contributed to the transformation of Rizal's consciousness. In this arrest, Matias, the brother of Rizal's friend Jose Maria Basa, was involved as he allegedly supported anti-friar propaganda. When he heard this, he wrote a letter to his colleague Mariano Ponce, and said that:

Though we must regret this (wave of arrests) as a private misfortune, we must applaud it as a general good... Let them commit abuses, let there be arrests, exile, executions, good! Let Destiny be fulfilled! The day on which they inflict martyrdom on our innocent families for our fault, farewell, profriar government and perhaps farewell, Spanish Government!

(Rizal's Letter to Mariano Ponce on April 18, 1889)

Lastly, of course, was when Rizal's family was directly affected by Spanish persecution: 1) Manuel Hidalgo, his brother-in-law, was deported to Bohol; 2) their house in Calamba was demolished; and 3) his parents and sisters were exiled in different parts of the archipelago. The pain caused by this event enabled him to immortalize and vindicate the people of Calamba in Chapter 10 of his second novel *El Filibusterismo* (Wealth and Misery). A year had passed, but he could not forget the gruesome memory of Calamba evictions. All these made him realize that the best solution to combat the Spanish tyranny was to return to the Philippines. In a letter to Mariano Ponce, he said:

I am thinking of returning to the Philippines) as soon as possible, and let God say what is to happen... If one must die, let one die at least in his country, for his country and in the name of his country.

(Rizal's Letter to Mariano Ponce on July 1890)

Rizal and the Philippine Revolution of 1896

It has been pointed out earlier that Rizal indeed aspired for a separate Filipino nation. His role in the Philippine Revolution of 1896 can now be easily understood. One must realize that for Rizal, the ultimate goal was independence and the clamor for it manifested in many ways. Reform was one method, as clearly seen in his proposed constitution of La Liga Filipina in 1892. For him, however, reform was not the end of it all. One might argue that Rizal was ambivalent, or in the words of Historian Teodoro Agoncillo, a "reluctant revolutionary." He had reservations since it might cost lives. What he had in mind was a clear method of achieving the goal of independence.

According to Rizal, Filipinos should know the enlightenment of people, the development of a national sentiment, and a revolutionary spirit through liberty and education. Rizal was consistent in all of his writings after 1890 that the revolution must come from the "inside" meaning that the revolution should not change people; but rather we needed change within ourselves and this must come first before staging a revolution.

The Filipinos must become disciplined and follow ethical standards. A learned man as he was, reading books of past revolutions in the world, Rizal was hesitant to stage an armed revolution only to replace the old colonial masters with new sets of tyrants. Padre Florentino, a character of *El Filibusterismo* reflected the state of mind of Rizal when he said that the slaves of today will be the tyrants of tomorrow." After all, Rizal adhered to the idea of Social Darwinism that any society will lead to freedom and emancipation after a long process of evolution. So, to him, why not wait for it if the goal could be achieved without bloodshed? The treasure chest beneath the sea floor explained it all.

We shall now return to the two main evidence of Constantino's attack on Rizal: Pio Valenzuela's prison testimony in 1896 and the repudiation for revolution in Rizal's

December 15, 1898 manifesto to certain Filipinos. The first was the opinion of Rizal about the Katipunan and the possible revolution.

Pio Valenzuela was the one assigned to visit Rizal in Dapitan to tell him about the existence of a secret society, which was long preparing for a revolution since 1892. The classical reply of Rizal according to Valenzuela was that Rizal was not in favor of armed resistance: "No, no, no, a thousand times, no," Rizal allegedly uttered. But Valenzuela had a change of heart because in his 1914 memoir, he modified his statement by telling that Rizal had actually supported the revolution only if his standards were met:

- 1) support from wealthy Filipinos:
- 2) induce Antonio Luna, an educated person in terms of western military strategy in the movement; and lastly
- 3) neutralize the unsympathetic to the cause of the secret society.

Valenzuela also emphasized that Rizal advised him and the Katipunan to continue the revolution, and that when found out, they should kill before the Spaniards kill them. When asked if there were disagreements among the high ranks of the Katipunan regarding the opinion of Rizal, Valenzuela pointed out that there was no divide and members all agreed to Rizal; therefore, the clash between Rizal and Bonifacio, like what the present-day critics of Rizal created, was non-existent in the 19th century Philippines.

Though one may argue the invalidity of the 1914 statement of Valenzuela because it was said long after his encounter with Rizal in Dapitan, one cannot deny the fact that his first statement about the rejection of Rizal to Katipunan may also be not credible. Pio Valenzuela was under duress that time and his motive of cleaning the name of Rizal was made in the context of Rizal's impending trial and execution. Nevertheless, whatever the true statement was, the Filipinos, especially uneducated Filipinos, had another picture of Rizal in their minds. We will discuss this in the next part.

In regard to the open condemnation of Rizal to Philippine Revolution, according to Guerrero, the statement of Rizal was never believed by the Judge Advocate General, thus he refused to approve and issue it to people. Rizal's true purpose was to clear his name because he was then fighting for his life. Like a lawyer who was set to face trial, Rizal was attacking the credibility of his prosecutors when he offered his manifesto. Therefore, it was normal then to deviate himself from the revolution which in the first place, the foundation was beyond his knowledge. Below is the complaint of the Judge Advocate General on the manifesto of Rizal, as quoted by Guerrero:

[Rizal] limits himself to condemning the present rebellious movement as premature and because he considers its success impossible at this time, but suggesting between the lines the independence dreamed of can be achieved by

means less dishonorable than those used at present by the rebels when the [level of culture of the people could serve as a most valuable factor in the struggle and as the guarantee of its success. For Rizal it is a question of opportunity, not of principles or objectives. His manifesto can be condensed into these words: Faced with the proofs of defeat, lay down your arms, my countrymen; I shall lead you to the Promised Land on a later day'. [426-427]

Rizal and the Revolutionist

The other side of Rizal's contribution to the Philippine Revolution should not be overlooked. Remember that most Filipinos had not read Rizal, for all his works were written in Spanish. Masses had in fact generated a different meaning of Rizal's persona based on the information they gathered or heard. According to historian Reynaldo C. Tleto, the fact that Rizal was seen in a very "un-Ilustrado" way made the person more important to the revolution participated by religious Filipinos. Rizal was considered the Tagalog Christ, the epitome of Filipino sacrifice and his death by firing squad was a re-enactment of the passion and death of Christ. His words in his *Mi Ultimo Adios*, translated in Tagalog by Andres Bonifacio, became the rallying cry, a battle chant invoked during the actual battles for the Filipinos who believed in resurrection and salvation.

LESSON 19

Sacrifice and Martyrdom

Lesson Outcomes:

At the end of the lesson, the students should be able to:

1. describe the sacrifices of Rizal to achieve his goal;
2. illustrate the link between his martyrdom and the revolution; and
3. synthesize the meaning of sacrifice then and now.

Lesson Introduction:

As life was snuffed out of him, great did he become. Rizal is known to have given his life for his beloved muse, the Philippines. In all his undertakings, he knew his ultimate goal was to lift up his motherland at the risk of his own life. Understanding what he went through at various stages in his life opens a different avenue of Rizal being a man first, then a martyr.

Lesson Discussion:

There are a lot sacrifices made by Rizal in his lifetime. Paciano, his older brother, arranged for him to study abroad. The young Rizal has already reached his limit in the schools domestically and the brewing censorship and inequality did not provide him with an environment conducive for learning.

His first sacrifice was separation from his family so he could pursue his scholastic career abroad. Imagine the whirlwind of emotions he had to go through in order to unlock a better world! Rizal had to adapt quickly and transform into an adult for he was now alone with no brother or mother to lead him.

His pursuit of his love for arts was overshadowed by his medical degree. As a young man, he took up classes on the Bellas artes (Fine Arts) in Escuela de San Fernando, but did not pursue it for the main reason that upon his arrival in Spain, he continued his degree in Medicine. While undergoing medical school, he became deeply immersed with the scientific method of problem solving.

In order to treat a patient, one must find the cause first. As he studied the human anatomy and became fascinated about the different organs of the body, he finally decided to specialize in the field of ophthalmology. As he began to see the truth, he slowly knew that there was always a solution to every dilemma; so he transformed his mindset and focused on the ills of the country.

On the morning of that fateful day, December 30, 1896, Rizal was made to walk from his cell in Fort Santiago all the way to Bagumbayan. The medical doctor checked his pulse and was surprised by the evidence of his calmness.

Upon his final moments, Rizal remained firm that his death would also be part of the fight to liberate his dear Philippines. As he offered his life that day, Rizal became enshrined into the martyrs of heroes who fell victim to the harsh Spanish colonial government who was afraid of what Rizal could do to the colonizers.

Upon hearing news of his death, the Katipuneros in their respective stronghold continued their struggle for emancipation knowing full well of the sacrifice brought forth by one of their inspiring figures. Though he may not be there to lead them, Rizal brought to light the shared angst and provided a new hope for his fellow Filipinos.

LESSON 20

Rizal's Concept of Being a "Filipino" and Filipino Nationalism

Lesson Outcomes:

At the end of the lesson, the students should be able to:

1. identify Rizal's concept of the Filipino nation and nationalism;
2. analyze the writings which contain his idea of nation and nationalism; and
3. offer a new approach in the process of nation-building.

Lesson Introduction:

Rizal's greatest achievement was by giving the natives of the Philippines their identity. He was the first man who actually branded the Filipinos as "Indio", thus making him the "First Filipino" according to Historian Leon Ma. Guerrero. Aside from this, he wanted to provide the Filipinos confidence in the past, faith in the present, and hope for the future.

This lesson aims to discuss Rizal's concept of Filipino nationalism and identity to instill the capacity of anyone to dictate his/her own self.

Lesson Discussion:

Rizal's encounter with Morga's *Sucesos* at the British Museum and his intensive research there sparked his long interest to combat colonial ideologies of lazy natives and ingrate Filipinos through the appeal of history. Two essays were published in *La Solidaridad* due to this "Filipinas Dentro de Cien Anos" (1889-1890) and "Sobre la Indolencia de los Filipinos" (1890). These works contained his ideas on national sentiment or nationalism.

But before we delve into his idea on national sentiment, his concept of a nation is necessary to be established. Rizal's basic principle of a nation is the *Vox populi, vox dei* (the voice of the people is the voice of God). It means that the ruler, whenever he/she exerts power over the subjects, that ruler has political obligations to uplift the wellbeing of his/her subjects. The ruler, however, can in any way repress the subject.

In such case, the subjects must perfect themselves despite perverted inclinations (like the tendencies toward indolence). It is therefore one's obligation to overcome struggles. Thus, when people aspire to harness their potentials by opposing injustice and promoting common good, they are actually fulfilling God's will. For Rizal, a community, a

nation, therefore, is a moral community founded on ethical principles of justice and the common good.

What was then Rizal's notion of national sentiment? Based on Rizal's *Filipinas dentro de cien Anos* and *Sobre la Indolencia de los Filipinos*, "national" means "collective." as opposed to "individual." It refers to the "common good" as against personal. In *Filipinas dentro de cien Anos*, he spoke of another concept-"the spirit or soul of the people" (*el espiritu nacional*). This can be interpreted as "the sense of solidarity by the realization of a common misfortune and a common abasement." al sentiment for Rizal was about equipping the collective people with.

Thus, national sentiment for Rizal was about equipping the collective people with awareness of evils of the colonial system. Unfortunately, in *Sobre la Indolencia de los Filipinos*, Rizal said that "a man in the Philippines is only an individual, he is not a member of a nation." What the Filipinos needed to combat this was liberty and education. These methods give "soul" necessary for a nation. A nation with soul, on the other hand, will encourage solidarity, sense of dignity, and concern for justice, hence, not vulnerable for tyrannical rule. All these traits were obviously absent in Simoun. No wonder Rizal killed him in his second novel. What the country needed was not a person like him who ran by personal interest, but rather an Elias, who positioned the collective good of the nation above anything. The culmination of his ideas on national sentiment was set to apply in

his Liga Filipina, but sadly this organization was cut short when he was deported to Dapitan.

His concept of a Filipino was connected to what has been discussed earlier. For Rizal, being a Filipino by blood was not enough. A person who has love for the country, concern for the common good, and realizes the collective sufferings of Filipinos--that is to say a "Filipino by heart" can be considered a Filipino. Rizal's Austrian friend Ferdinand Blumentritt, whom he loved so much, was a "Filipino" for him. Thus, being a Filipino has to be proven, it is not something that one has it is not something that one has when born; but rather it is a project.